



CITY: Pg 3

CM: All parties, leaders who opposed women's quota bill rejected by voters



NATION: Pg 6

Mann meets Prez seeking cancellation of 6 MPs' RS membership



FILM: Pg 14

Meet the Indians who ruled Met Gala 2026

ON MAY 9 AT ICONIC BRIGADE PARADE GROUND

BJP govt to take oath on Tagore's birth anniv

SHAH MADE CHIEF OBSERVER OF BENGAL, MOHAN CHARAN MAJHI CO-OBSERVER

PRADIP CHATTERJEE

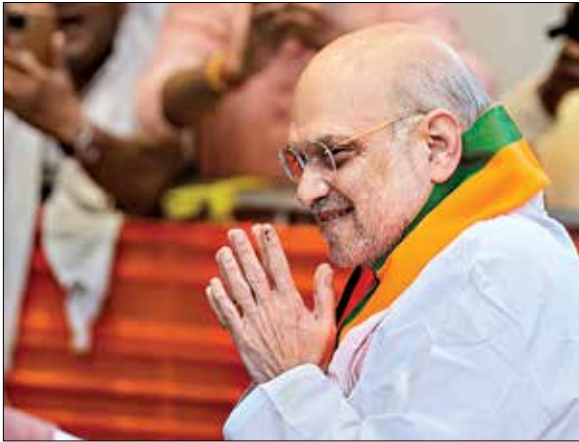
KOLKATA: The BJP is set to form its first-ever government in West Bengal, with the swearing-in ceremony slated for Saturday, May 9—coinciding with the birth anniversary of Nobel laureate Rabindranath Tagore.

Union Home minister Amit Shah, appointed as the party's chief observer for Bengal, along with Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi as co-observer, will hold a crucial meeting with all BJP MLAs on Wednesday to decide the legislature party leader.

Meanwhile, it is learnt that PM Modi held a meeting with Amit Shah and Nitin Nabin, along with the party's top leadership in Delhi, to finalise the next Chief Minister of Bengal.

Sources said Adhikari is the frontrunner for the post. Samik Bhattacharya, who is the state BJP president, was also a contender. Agnimitra Paul could have been a possibility if the party chose a woman as chief minister.

Once in Kolkata, Shah is expected to not only oversee the selection of the BJP's legislature party leader but also



Amit Shah being welcomed to celebrate BJP's performance in Assembly elections, in new Delhi, on Monday

FILE PIC/PTI

HISTORIC MOMENT

» Amit Shah is expected to not only oversee the selection of the BJP's legislature party leader but also finalise the party's Chief Ministerial face during the meeting

» Suwendu Adhikari, who secured victories from both Nandigram and Bhowanipore, has emerged as a strong contender for the top post

» Samik Bhattacharya on Tuesday confirmed that the party considered May 9 for the oath-taking ceremony of the new government as it coincides with Pochishe Baisakh

finalise the party's chief ministerial face during the meeting in city.

Suwendu Adhikari, who secured victories from both Nandigram and Bhowanipore, has emerged as a strong contender for the top post, amid growing speculation.

Adhikari defeated Trinamool Congress (TMC) supremo Mamata Banerjee in Bhowanipore. According to BJP sources, both leaders will supervise the selection of the legislature party

leader who will become the chief minister.

State BJP president Samik Bhattacharya on Tuesday confirmed that the party considered May 9 for the oath-taking ceremony of the new government as it coincides with "Pochishe Baisakh" in the Bengali calendar.

Sources said that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and several top BJP leaders are likely to attend the swearing-in ceremony.

Rabindranath Tagore's Jayanti is traditionally celebrated on the

25th day of the Bengali month Boishakh, known as 'Pochishe' Boishakh. In 2026, it falls on May 9.

BJP spent the entire campaign assuring Bengalis that it understood their culture, their language, and their soul, and now, by choosing Tagore's birth anniversary for the swearing-in, it would be an attempt to send a message across. Though the BJP has not officially confirmed a date yet.

PM Modi, while addressing his final

Continued on P4

Trump congratulates PM Modi on BJP's poll victory

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump has congratulated Prime Minister Narendra Modi on his "historic and decisive" election victory, a White House spokesman said on Tuesday.

"Just last month on their phone call, President Trump expressed

to Prime Minister Modi his admiration and how lucky India is to have him as its leader," White House Spokesman Kush Desai said.

"The President congratulates Prime Minister Modi on this recent, historic, and decisive election victory," he added.

I haven't lost, won't resign, says Mamata, alleges 'poll loot'

AGNIHOTRI GUPTA

KOLKATA: A day after the election results were declared, outgoing Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee refused to resign, asserting, "I have not lost. I will not resign. I will not go to Raj Bhavan... the question does not arise."

Claiming that the results did not reflect the true mandate of the people, Banerjee alleged

Continued on P4

PM condemns attacks on Fujairah; says India stands with UAE

3 Indians were injured in attack

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday condemned the recent strikes on the United Arab Emirates' port city of Fujairah that left three Indian nationals injured, and reaffirmed New Delhi's support for the Gulf nation.

The remarks came a day after the attack targeted a key oil industry zone in Fujairah, an incident the UAE has attributed to Iran. In a message posted on social media, Modi said, "Strongly condemn the attacks on the UAE that resulted in injuries to three Indian nationals. Targeting civilians and infrastructure is unacceptable."

He added that "India stands in firm solidarity with the UAE and reiterates its support for the peaceful resolution of all issues through dialogue and diplomacy."

The developments unfold against rising tensions in the Strait of Hormuz, where a fragile ceasefire between the United States and Iran has come under strain. Modi pointed to the broader impli-



FILE PHOTO

TAKEAWAYS

» PM says targeting civilians and infrastructure is unacceptable... India stands in firm solidarity with the UAE

» Strike hit major oil zone in Fujairah; UAE blames Iran

» MEA calls attacks "unacceptable"; seeks immediate halt to hostilities

» Spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal backs dialogue, diplomacy, lawful maritime commerce

cations of instability in the region, stating that ensuring "safe and unimpeded navigation through the Strait of Hormuz is vital for enduring regional

Continued on P4

In today's paper

CITY

HAIL, STORMS COOL CITY 3

NATION

HIMANTA TO SUBMIT RESIGNATION TO GUV 6

EDIT

MIGRATION EQUATION 7

INTERNATIONAL

RUSSIAN STRIKES KILL 5 IN KYIV 10

SPORT

SAMSON TAKES DOWN DC 10

BUSINESS

M&M Q4 PROFIT RISES TO `5,259.91 CR 12

Cabinet clears proposal to raise SC strength from 34 to 38 judges

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved a proposal to expand the strength of the Supreme Court from 34 judges to 38, including the Chief Justice of India, in a move aimed at addressing the growing workload of the apex court.

Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the government will introduce a bill in the next session of Parliament to formalise the increase. "A bill will be brought to raise the number of judges by four," he said.

At present, the sanctioned strength of the top court stands at 34 judges, including the CJI, with two positions currently vacant. Once Parliament approves the proposed legislation and it comes into force, the total strength will rise to 38.

Continued on P4

CBI books own Dy SP, his wife for amassing disproportionate assets

NEW DELHI: The CBI has registered a fresh case of amassing disproportionate assets against its own deputy superintendent of police, already under probe in a bribery case while posted in the Banking, Securities and Fraud branch, officials said on Tuesday. The agency has booked the Dy SP and his wife for amassing over Rs 98.33 lakh during 2021-24, which is 87 per cent above his known sources of income, they said.

The couple could not offer a satisfactory explanation for the assets, following which a case under the provisions of the Prevention of Corruption Act was registered against them, they said. The DySP was already facing a probe in a 2024 case for allegedly collecting Rs five crore in bribes from companies and individuals under probe, they said.AGENCIES

STALIN STEPS DOWN AS CM

Tamil Nadu: Cong, Left parties emerge key to govt formation

Vijay meets MLAs to finalise Cabinet, swearing-in likely May 7

MPOST BUREAU

CHENNAI: A day after his TVK party's stunning win that marked his blockbuster political debut, capturing 108 seats in the 234-member Tamil Nadu Assembly, TVK chief superstar Vijay is meeting his MLAs at his Pattinampakkam residence here to finalise Cabinet formation.

In a historic upset, the TVK delivered a shock defeat to the DMK, with party chief and Chief Minister MK Stalin losing his Kolathur seat. The AIADMK was pushed to a distant third, winning 47 seats. The TVK's impressive victory marked the first time in nearly six decades that Tamil Nadu's entrenched Dravidian duopoly has been decisively broken. Vijay is likely to take an oath as Tamil Nadu Chief Minister on May 7, with nine Cabinet ministers likely to be sworn in along with him.

The meeting is also expected to discuss potential alliances, as the party has fallen short of the simple majority mark by 10 seats as it has only 108 members in the 234-member Tamil Nadu Assembly.

Sources said the actor-politician is exploring talks with the Congress, Left parties, and other smaller regional outfits, including the Viduthala Chiruthaigal Kathi (VCK), CPI(M), CPI, and the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML), to secure numbers for a coalition arrangement.

Notably, the Congress, VCK, CPI, CPI(M) and IUML are currently part of the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance (SPA). In the April 23 polls, the Congress won five seats, while IUML, CPI, CPI(M) and VCK secured two seats each in the



TVK chief Vijay arrives at party headquarters at Panaiyur, in Chennai, on Tuesday

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

» TVK short of majority by 10 seats in Assembly

» Talks underway with Congress, Left, and regional parties

» Potential allies include VCK, CPI(M), CPI, IUML

» Congress won 5 seats; IUML, CPI, CPI(M), VCK got 2 each

» Vijay stakes claim with Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar to form government

» Seeks chance to prove majority; thanks Narendra Modi for praise

234-member Assembly.

Meanwhile, M K Stalin resigned as Chief Minister, asserting that his party will function effectively in the opposition.

A source in the Congress, a major constituent of the DMK-led

Continued on P4

MPOST BUREAU

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: A day after the Congress-led UDF swept back to power in Kerala, the mood in the alliance is one of joy, relief and cautious hope. At the same time, discussions on forming the new government have already begun, with leaders holding meetings and informal talks to decide the next steps.

For senior leaders, the win is not just political—it is emotional. Many of them have described it as a



Congress leader VD Satheesan with supporters, at Ernakulam Railway Station in Kochi, on Tuesday

moment of "people's trust returning".

Alongside the celebrations, moves have begun

among senior party leaders for the Chief Minister's post.

There are three major

contenders in the state Congress for the post: Leader of the Opposition V D Satheesan, senior leader Ramesh Chennithala, and AICC general secretary and Lok Sabha MP K C Venugopal.

Since the Congress has 63 seats on its own, it is not under pressure to yield to alliance partners.

As part of the process of deciding the next chief minister, an AICC team will be deputed by the party high command and, along with AICC general secretary and

Continued on P4

Govt clears Rs 18,100 cr ECLGS 5.0 to support MSMEs and airlines hit by West Asia conflict

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet on Tuesday cleared a fresh round of support under the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme, approving an outlay of Rs 18,100 crore to ease financial strain on micro, small and medium enterprises and the aviation sector affected by the ongoing West Asia conflict.

The programme, titled ECLGS 5.0, is expected to facilitate additional credit flow of about Rs 2.55 lakh crore, including Rs 5,000 crore earmarked for airlines. Announc-

“THE PROGRAMME, TITLED ECLGS 5.0, IS EXPECTED TO FACILITATE ADDITIONAL CREDIT FLOW OF ABOUT RS 2.55 LAKH CRORE”

ing the decision, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the scheme was designed to address stress in sectors hit by disruptions linked to the conflict.

"The scheme has been brought to address the stress in MSME and

airline sectors due to the West Asia conflict," he told reporters while briefing on Cabinet decisions.

Under the framework, passenger airlines will be eligible for loans of up to 100 per cent of their peak credit, capped at Rs 1,500 crore. Other institutions can avail up to 20 per cent of their fund-based working capital, with a ceiling of Rs 100 crore.

According to an official statement, the initiative seeks to help businesses navigate operational challenges arising from geopolitical tensions. It noted that the scheme is intended to

Continued on P4

INDIA-UAE, INDIA-US AMONG TOP 10 MIGRATION CORRIDORS

India remains top remittance recipient country in the world with \$137 bn: UN

MPOST BUREAU

UNITED NATIONS: India continued to dominate global migration-linked financial flows in 2024, receiving more than 137 billion dollars in remittances and remaining the only country to cross the 100 billion dollar mark, according to the latest findings released by the International Organization for Migration. The World Migration Report 2026, published on Tuesday, presents a sweeping picture of migration trends, showing India not only at the centre of global remittance flows but also deeply embedded in major migration corridors and diaspora-driven



economic networks.

The report identifies India as the world's leading recipient of remittances, followed by Mexico,

KEY POINTS

» Only country to cross 100 billion dollars in remittance inflows

» International Organization for Migration report ranks India first, followed by Mexico, Philippines, France

» Remittances to India rose from 53.48 billion (2010) to 137.67 billion (2024)

» India among countries with higher share of male emigrants

» India has higher share of female immigrants domestically

» Over 620,000 Indian students studied abroad in 2022, second after China

» Asia accounts for largest share of global international students

with the Philippines and France also ranking among the top four. While several countries recorded strong inflows, India stood sig-

nificantly ahead, receiving more than 137 billion dollars in 2024. This milestone reflects a steady upward

Continued on P4

SILENT HUNTER



A white-throated kingfisher at National Zoological Park, in New Delhi

PTI

TODDLER'S DEATH IN MUKUNDPUR

Jr engineer sacked for uncovered drain lapse

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A junior engineer from the Irrigation and Flood Control Department was dismissed on the directions of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, over the death of a girl who fell into an open drain in the Mukundpur area, a CMO statement said on Tuesday.

Gupta expressed deep sorrow over the tragic death of the two-year-old girl, saying that the incident was extremely distressing and alarming.

The girl died on April 3 after falling into a three-foot-wide and four-foot-deep drain that was left open after recent desilting. Her family had blamed the civic officials for negligence.

The chief minister said the negligence in covering the drain was unacceptable and directed action against the



Officials would be held accountable for any form of negligence: CM

junior engineer.

Acting swiftly on the chief minister's directives, the department dismissed the contractual junior engineer from service with immediate effect, the statement said.

Gupta directed all the departments concerned to

KEY POINTS

» Acting swiftly on the chief minister's directives, the dept dismissed the contractual junior engineer from service with immediate effect

» Gupta directed all the departments concerned to identify open drains, other hazardous sites within their jurisdictions that pose a threat to life

identify open drains and other hazardous sites within their respective jurisdictions that pose a threat to life and property.

She warned that officials would be held accountable for any form of negligence, and strict action would be taken.

Vivek Vihar fire tragedy: Residents push for urgent safety overhaul after 9 deaths

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In the aftermath of a devastating fire that killed nine people in east Delhi's Vivek Vihar, locals have begun mobilising to address glaring safety lapses, deciding to hold meetings every 15 days to discuss fire preparedness and structural changes in residential buildings.

On May 3, a fire broke at a four-storey building in Vivek Vihar Phase-I, rapidly spreading from the rear portion and engulfing flats from the first to the fourth floors. Nine people from two families, including a toddler, died while several others were rescued.

Initial investigation suggested an air-conditioner blast on a lower floor triggered the blaze, which intensified due to strong winds.

The building's design -- including a single central staircase, locked terrace access, and iron grills at the rear -- significantly



hampered escape and rescue efforts.

Against this backdrop, residents in nearby blocks and localities have started discussions on improving safety mechanisms.

"We have decided that meetings will be conducted every after 15 days and will discuss several way out during any fire-related incidents," a local resident Rakesh Singh stated.

He added that the meetings would also focus on the risks

posed by electronic door locking systems, which can fail during emergencies.

"Residents will also discuss about electronic door locking systems as such doors do not open in emergency situations. We got to know that some of the family members were not able to come out of the building due to electronic locking system and they charred to death," he said.

Another resident, Shiv Sharma, who owns two flats

CM meets fire victims' families

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta met the families of Vivek Vihar fire tragedy victims on Tuesday, saying her government is committed to providing every possible assistance to them.

In a post on X, the chief minister said, taking the unfortunate incident as a

"grave" warning, instructions have been issued to all the departments concerned to prevent recurrence by strictly following the highest standards of fire safety.

"Any negligence or compromise on fire safety standards will not be tolerated," she said. MPOST

on the second floor of a building in B-Block located around 100 metres from the fire site, highlighted a long-standing but unwritten practice that may have contributed to the fatalities. "It is an unsaid rule that those who stay in top flats can only use the rooftop and they even lock the rooftop. Such was the case in the fire incident, as due to lock, many people were unable to reach the rooftop and died there," he said.

He stressed that keep-

ing terrace access open for all during emergencies could save lives. "Had it not been locked, more lives could have been saved. During the meetings, we will raise this issue and ensure that rooftops are not locked so that people can reach there in emergency conditions," Sharma added.

Residents also pointed to structural barriers such as iron grills and haphazardly parked cars that restrict evacuation routes.

REVENGE KILLING OVER 2018 MURDER

Ggm cops arrest 2 accused for murder of ex-NSG commando

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GURUGRAM: Two persons have been arrested for allegedly murdering ex-NSG commando Sunder, alias Fauji, in Kasan village, Manesar, last week, police said on Tuesday.

The accused were identified as Gulshan, alias Gullu, alias Ganesh (20), and Kartik Chauhan, alias Chhota Rohan (20), both residents of Kasan village.

Police said they recovered two pistols used in the crime from their possession. The main accused, Kartik Chauhan, works at a water supply



plant in Gurugram.

Karthik, along with his friend, had gunned down 55-year-old Sunder in revenge for his father's killing.

"During interrogation, Kartik revealed that in 2018, his father, Bahadur Chauhan, was murdered by Sunder. On

March 29, Sunder, who was serving a life sentence for the murder, had come to his village on parole for his niece's wedding. Seeking revenge, Karthik and his friend Gulshan shot down Sunder. We are questioning both the accused," a Gurugram police spokesperson said.

The incident took place on April 30, around 8.30 am, when Sunder was out on a morning walk. Karthik and his friend, riding a motorcycle, confronted Sunder, pulled their pistols and shot him dead. Eye-witnesses claimed that around five rounds were fired.

News at a glance

IGI AIRPORT SEES 5 FLIGHT DIVERSIONS

NEW DELHI: Five flights were diverted at the Delhi airport on Tuesday evening due to inclement weather conditions, according to an official. Many parts of the national capital witnessed rain and thunderstorms. The official said five flights that were to land at the Delhi airport were diverted due to the bad weather conditions. The Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGIA) in the national capital is the country's largest airport and handles more than 1,300 flight movements daily.

HIT-AND-RUN CASE: DRIVER APPREHENDED FROM BIHAR

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested a 20-year-old truck driver, Tuntun alias Titu, for a hit-and-run that killed two cousins after an IPL match. The accident occurred on April 27 near Mahadev Road in the Parliament Street area, when a truck rammed a motorcycle from behind. Victims Yagya Bhatia (20) and his 14-year-old cousin Abhav were declared dead at Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital. The accused, who fled to Bihar, was arrested from Samastipur on May 4. Police traced him through CCTV.

DFS to roll out tech overhaul with AI, GPS & GIS systems as manpower shortage persists

NEW DELHI: Facing a sharp surge in fire emergencies, the Delhi Fire Services (DFS) is set to roll out a technology-driven overhaul, including a centralised command and control centre equipped with Artificial Intelligence (AI), GPS and GIS-based systems this year, even as it struggles with staff shortages and outdated infrastructure, officials said.

As fire calls ring incessantly across the national capital, the department is grappling with acute manpower constraints, obsolete communication systems and largely manual operations that often slow down response time.

The DFS currently has 2,459 operational staff across 71 fire stations, a fraction of the around 24,000 personnel and 120 stations prescribed under the guidelines laid down by Standing Fire Advisory Committee under the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) guidelines, highlighting a significant gap in capacity. Amid rising incidents, the DFS is planning to set up the tech-enabled control centre within this year to streamline emergency response and reduce reliance on manual processes. "Currently, many of our systems are manual, including the control room, which can delay operations and leave

scope for discrepancies due to lack of recorded data," Deputy Chief Fire Officer A K Malik stated. "The proposed system will reduce manual intervention, enable real-time tracking of calls and resources, and help deploy the nearest vehicle with optimised routing," he said.

Officials said fire tenders will be fitted with Mobile Data Terminals (MDTs) to improve coordination, while plans are also underway to install cameras in vehicles to enable live monitoring of operations from the DFS headquarters.

Communication remains another concern, with outdated wireless handsets forcing per-

sonnel to rely heavily on mobile phones, which may fail during emergencies. "We are procuring new wireless sets and plan to install additional towers to strengthen communication networks," Malik said. The shortage of manpower has also put pressure on existing staff, especially during peak summer months when fire incidents rise and leaves are often curtailed to maintain operational readiness.

Delhi Fire Service plans expansion, seeks more staff as fire deaths rise to 42. April saw 2,663 calls. Fleet upgraded with tenders, QRVs and bikes to boost response time. PFI

Cyber fraud syndicate busted, 5 caught: Cops

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Five persons have been arrested by the Delhi Police Cyber Cell for their alleged role in an interstate cyber fraud racket that duped victims through fake online investment and task-based schemes.

The case was registered at the Cyber Police Station in East district following a complaint by a New Ashok Nagar resident, who reported being cheated of Rs 1,01,869 after being lured via a WhatsApp group offering digital marketing tasks and high-return investment opportunities.

Police said the accused, apprehended from Udhampur Singh Nagar, were part of an organised syndicate supplying mule bank accounts to cyber criminals across the country. Investigators have linked transactions worth Rs 3,40,877 to multiple complaints on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal.

Technical analysis of financial trails, KYC documents and digital footprints revealed that part of the defrauded amount was routed through accounts



Police stated the group earned commissions for facilitating transactions

operated by the accused in Uttarakhand. One account, held by Raj Bachhar, received Rs 50,000, which was subsequently transferred through multiple accounts, including one linked to Sameer Bachhar, to obscure the money trail.

The remaining accused—Rohit Ray, Rohit Mistri and Harish Sarkar—allegedly acted as coordinators sourcing additional accounts. Police said the group earned commissions for facilitating transactions. Five mobile phones were seized, and further investigation is underway.

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The University of Delhi has extended the last date for submission of examination forms for the May-June 2026 session to May 7 (11:59 p.m.), providing a final opportunity for students across Regular, NCWEB, and School of Open Learning (SOL) programmes. The extension is applicable with a late fee, and authorities have stated that no further extension will be granted.

Students have been urged to complete the process through the university's official portal to avoid missing their examinations. However, the announcement comes amid growing unrest among SOL students, who have raised concerns about incomplete syllabus coverage and irregular classes.

A section of students recently staged a protest outside the Vice-Chancellor's office, alleging that only 10 to 15 classes were conducted during the semester, leaving substantial portions of the syllabus unfinished. They questioned the decision to proceed with examinations under such conditions, warning that it could



Student groups described the situation as a case of 'academic mismanagement'

negatively impact results.

Student groups described the situation as a case of "academic mismanagement," citing inadequate teaching engagement in the distance learning system. Many claimed that limited academic exposure has affected their preparation for the upcoming examinations.

The SOL administration, however, denied the allegations, maintaining that classes have been conducted in accordance with distance education

TAKEAWAYS

» Announcement comes amid growing unrest among SOL students, who have raised concerns about incomplete syllabus coverage...

» A section of students recently staged a protest outside the VC's office, alleging that only 10 to 15 classes were conducted during the semester, leaving substantial portions of the syllabus unfinished

norms. Officials stated that the academic schedule and resources provided are in line with established guidelines.

The situation has drawn attention to broader concerns regarding the effectiveness of open learning systems and the gap between administrative assurances and student experiences. As the revised deadline approaches, students are navigating both procedural requirements and concerns over academic preparedness.

SAROJINI NGR: Easy availability of button knives sparks safety debate



PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Switchblade, or button-actuated, knives are being openly sold for as little as Rs 250 in Sarojini Nagar Market, raising fresh concerns over public safety in one of the capital's busiest shopping areas, frequented daily by large crowds, including students and families.

Many of these knives fall into a legal grey area. Under a 2024 ruling by the Supreme Court of India, knives with blades exceeding 7.62 cm in length and 1.72 cm in breadth may attract regulation under the Arms Act. Smaller knives, such as those commonly seen in the market, are not automatically prohibited unless linked to specific conditions such as manufacture, sale



for trade, or intent to use unlawfully. Recent observations show compact folding and spring-action knives being sold alongside everyday goods, with blades typically measuring around 5.5-6 cm in length and narrow widths. Despite their small size, their sharp edges and rapid deployment mechanism make them capable of causing serious injury, particularly in crowded or volatile situations.

Legal experts note that while possession of such knives may not be explicitly illegal, their easy availability in busy public spaces remains a concern. The distinction between legality and safety is especially significant in dense marketplaces, where even minor altercations can escalate quickly.

FOUR-HOUR OPEN-HEART PROCEDURE REROUTES BLOOD FLOW

Day-old baby undergoes life-saving heart surgery

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A day-old pre-term newborn battling a rare and life-threatening heart defect was given a new lease of life after undergoing a complex open-heart surgery at a Delhi hospital, doctors said.

According to a statement by Fortis Escorts, Okhla, the infant was diagnosed with infradiaphragmatic total anomalous pulmonary venous connection (TAPVC), a rare congenital condition in which oxygen-rich blood from the lungs fails to return to the heart normally, leading to severe respiratory distress soon after birth.

"This was a highly critical



cardiac emergency where every minute mattered. Such conditions can be rapidly fatal if not treated immediately, but with timely surgery, these babies can go on to lead healthy lives," said Dr. KS Iyer, Chairman and Head of Paediatric and Congenital Heart Surgery at the hospital.

The condition, which affects

“The baby, born to a 33-year-old first-time mother, had been diagnosed with the anomaly during a routine antenatal ultrasound and later confirmed through a fetal echocardiogram”

about one in 10,000 live births, caused the newborn's lungs to become congested and prevented adequate oxygen supply to the body, making urgent surgical intervention critical, the hospital said.

The baby, born to a 33-year-old first-time mother, had been diagnosed with the anomaly during a routine antenatal

ultrasound and later confirmed through a fetal echocardiogram. The parents, both doctors from Patna, planned the delivery near the treatment facility to ensure immediate medical care after birth, it said.

The surgery was done on April 14 and the baby was born on April 13, they said, adding that soon after deliv-

ery, the newborn developed severe breathing difficulties and required respiratory support before being shifted to the intensive care unit. Then further evaluation reconfirmed the diagnosis, according to the hospital. Doctors said the infant underwent an emergency open-heart surgery lasting nearly four hours, during which oxygenated blood flow was rerouted to the left side of the heart, the only definitive treatment for the condition.

Following the procedure, the baby showed steady recovery, was gradually stabilised, and was discharged after 11 days in a stable condition, the hospital added.

Man held in Rs 1.2L UPI fraud case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested a 32-year-old man in connection with a mobile phone theft case linked to fraudulent UPI transactions worth over Rs 1.2 lakh, an official said on Tuesday.

The case pertains to an e-FIR registered at IGI Airport Metro police station after a mobile phone was stolen and subsequently used to carry out multiple unauthorised UPI transactions amounting to Rs 1,20,390, he said.

Police said the investigation relied on a multi-layered approach combining advanced cyber forensic tools with ground intelligence. An end-to-end analysis of 11 sus-



picious UPI transactions was carried out, along with profiling and physical verification of beneficiaries.

The probe revealed that the defrauded money was rapidly routed through multiple local merchant accounts, indicating a structured and well-planned fraud network, a senior police officer said.

During technical surveil-

lance, one of the key beneficiaries, identified as Neetu from Haryana's Safidon, was traced and examined. Her questioning led police to the prime accused, Kushagra Ahuja.

The accused had no fixed residence and frequently changed locations to evade arrest, making the investigation challenging. Multiple raids were conducted across Delhi and the National Capital Region based on technical inputs and surveillance.

On May 1, specific intelligence inputs indicated his presence near Kashmere Gate in north Delhi. Acting swiftly, police teams launched a focused operation and apprehended Ahuja after an intensive search near the ISBT area.

BJP LEADERS VISIT KALIBARI TEMPLE

CM: All parties, leaders who opposed women’s quota bill rejected by voters

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday said the electoral losses of parties and their leaders including Mamata Banerjee and M K Stalin were due to their opposition to the women’s quota bill in Parliament.

Gupta, accompanied by national BJP president Nitin Nabin and Delhi unit president Virendra Sachdeva among others, paid obeisance at the Kalibari temple in CR Park here, after BJP’s massive victories in West Bengal and Assam polls.

“All the parties and their leaders who opposed the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhinyam, whether DMK’s Stalin or Mamata Banerjee or Arvind Kejriwal are finding it difficult to answer to the people,” Gupta told reporters.

All major opposition parties including the Congress,



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Delhi BJP President Virendra Sachdeva and MP Bansuri Swaroj at Chittaranjan Park Kali Mandir, in Delhi

AAP, TMC and DMK voted against the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026, that sought to “operationalise” women’s reservation before the 2029 general elections by linking it to delimitation and increasing the number of Lok Sabha seats to 816. Gupta, the only woman chief minister

in all of the BJP-ruled states, also campaigned for the party ahead of the West Bengal Assembly polls.

She said the “historic mandate” received by the party in the state is a “turning point” for country’s politics.

The BJP secured a decisive majority in the 294-member

HIGHLIGHTS

- » All major opposition parties including the Congress, AAP, TMC and DMK voted against the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026
- » ‘It sought to operationalise women’s reservation before the 2029 general elections’ by linking it to delimitation and increasing the number of LS seats to 816

West Bengal assembly by winning 207 seats, ending Mamata Banerjee-led TMC’s 15-year rule in the state.

“Women of Bengal rejected fear and chose good governance,” Gupta said, adding that the politics of appeasement was “defeated in the state by development and nationalism”.

The parties that opposed the Bill in Parliament have been “decisively rejected” by the women of Bengal, the Delhi chief minister said. “The mothers and sisters of Bengal have sent a strong message through their votes,” she added.

The Bengal victory represents the success of policies focused on women’s dignity, safety and empowerment, she said. Despite an “atmosphere of fear and intimidation”, people in the state voted fearlessly and played a key role in strengthening democracy and establishing a government committed to good governance, Gupta said.

Crediting Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s leadership for the saffron flag “flying high from Gangotri to Gangasagar”, Gupta said the result clearly reflects the growing faith of public in the politics driven by development and nationalism.

CM announces major pay hike for vocational & SSA teachers

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a significant move aimed at strengthening Delhi’s education system and boosting teacher morale, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday announced a substantial salary hike for vocational teachers and those working under the Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan, calling it both a financial uplift and a recognition of their critical role.

The decision, approved during a Cabinet meeting, will benefit over a thousand vocational teachers and hundreds of educators working at Special Training Centres that focus on bringing out-of-school children back into the education system. Sharing the details, the Chief Minister said vocational teachers, around 1,131 in number, will now receive Rs.38,100 per month, a sharp increase from the earlier Rs.20,000–Rs.23,000 range.

Similarly, teachers at 784 centres under the Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan will see their salaries rise from Rs.21,000 to



Rs.35,420 per month. The revision effectively brings them at par with primary and upper primary teachers in Delhi.

Highlighting the intent behind the move, Rekha Gupta said, “This is not just a financial decision, but a recognition of the dedication and hard work of teachers who operate

in challenging conditions to bring children into the fold of education.” She added that the increase is expected to improve financial stability and motivation among teachers, noting, “Motivated and satisfied teachers are key to delivering quality education.”

The Chief Minister reiterated the government’s focus on inclusive education, stating, “Special Training Centres serve as a lifeline for children who have never been to school or have dropped out.” Emphasising the larger goal, she said, “Bringing them back into the mainstream remains a top priority, and teachers play the most crucial role in this effort.”

She also pointed to ongoing reforms, including better monitoring and parental engagement, adding, “Our aim is not just to enroll children in schools, but to inspire them to learn and secure their future.”

The move marks another step in the Delhi government’s push towards education reforms and strengthening foundational learning systems.

Crackdown on encroachment: Dy Mayor flags civic lapses in Kalkaji

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Deputy Mayor Dr. Monika Pant conducted an inspection of Kalkaji ward in the Municipal Corporation of Delhi’s (MCD) Central Zone, directing officials to take stringent action against illegal encroachments and civic violations in the area.

Accompanied by Central Zone Chairperson Yogita Singh, Deputy Commissioner Shashwat Saurabh, and other senior officials, Dr. Pant reviewed the status of sanitation, public amenities, and maintenance. During the visit, encroachments along Aggarwal Dharamshala Road were removed on the spot, with instructions issued for sus-



tained enforcement measures.

Expressing concern over the situation on Maa Anandamayi Marg, Dr. Pant noted the proliferation of street vendors occupying footpaths and the accumulation of litter.

She underscored that illegal encroachments and constructions would not be tolerated and warned of accountability

for officials found negligent in addressing such violations.

Residents who interacted with the Deputy Mayor raised complaints regarding poor sanitation, inadequate maintenance, and the dumping of Construction and Demolition (C&D) waste in and around local parks. The issue of unauthorised vending further exacerbating congestion was also highlighted.

Taking cognisance of these concerns, Dr. Pant directed officials to ensure regular clearance of C&D waste and ordered strict action against individuals involved in illegal dumping.

She reiterated the need for coordinated efforts to maintain public spaces and improve civic conditions.

Delhi government introduces lifetime validity for weights, measures licences; ends renewals

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a move aimed at simplifying regulatory processes, the Delhi government has introduced lifetime validity for licences issued to manufacturers, dealers and repairers of weights and measures, eliminating the need for periodic renewals.

The reform comes through amendments to the Delhi Legal Metrology (Enforcement) Rules, 2011, as part of the government’s ongoing “Deregulation Exercise 2.0.” Officials said the changes are intended to reduce compliance requirements and streamline procedures for businesses operating in the sector.

“Under the revised framework, licences granted upon payment of the prescribed fee will remain valid unless suspended...”

Under the revised framework, licences granted upon payment of the prescribed fee will remain valid unless suspended or cancelled by the competent authority. The amendments also remove the requirement for mandatory physical site inspections prior to licence approval, allowing applications to be processed on the basis of self-declaration. Industries and Food Supplies Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa described the reform as a step towards simplifying pro-

cesses, stating, “This is a decisive reform to make Delhi’s regulatory environment simpler, faster and more business-friendly. By reducing avoidable compliance and replacing repetitive approvals with trust-based systems, the government is creating real ease for enterprises on the ground.” He further said, “Delhi is moving towards a governance model that is reform-driven, trust-based and responsive to the needs of industry. Honest businesses should not be weighed

down by repetitive and avoidable procedures.” According to official data, the Weights and Measures Department currently oversees more than 600 active businesses in Delhi, including manufacturers, dealers and repairers.

The government is also working on a digital platform to transition the system towards a technology-driven interface for licensing and related services. Officials indicated that changes have been made to align schedules, forms and registers with the revised rules.

The reform is part of broader efforts to rationalise regulatory frameworks and reduce procedural requirements across departments.

Will appoint senior counsel to represent Kejriwal, Sisodia in excise case: Delhi HC

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Tuesday said it will appoint senior lawyers as amici curiae to represent AAP leaders Arvind Kejriwal, Manish Sisodia and Durgesh Pathak in the CBI case challenging their discharge in the liquor policy matter.

The leaders boycotted proceedings before Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma after she refused to recuse herself over allegations of conflict of interest and apprehension of bias.



“Leaders had written to the judge stating they would not participate in proceedings, invoking Mahatma Gandhi’s path of satyagraha”

The court deferred the hearing to May 8, observing it would proceed once legal representation is arranged.

“I will appoint an amicus... three seniors in this case,” the

judge said, confirming the move after Solicitor General Tushar Mehta sought clarification. The development follows an April 20 order dismissing recusal pleas filed by the

accused. The leaders had then written to the judge stating they would not participate in proceedings, invoking Mahatma Gandhi’s path of satyagraha.

On February 27, a trial court discharged Kejriwal, Sisodia and 21 others, saying the case could not withstand judicial scrutiny. The High Court is hearing the CBI’s plea challenging that order and has flagged certain findings of the trial court as prima facie erroneous.

FEATHERED FLEET



A flock of great white pelicans flies inside the National Zoological Park, in New Delhi, on Tuesday

GURUGRAM: The Gurugram Police on Tuesday razed an eight-story building being used to run allegedly a paying guest allegedly by drug smuggler Satpal alias Kalu in Kanhai, his native village.

The demolition was carried out by the police, in collaboration with the municipal corporation.

The property owned by the convicted smuggler was marked as illegal by the Anti-Narcotics Cell.

Satpal who has been convicted under the NDPS Act and faces more than half a dozen cases, they said. The police alleged that he had acquired this property using proceeds from drug trafficking.

More than 50 municipal employees were deployed while the building was demolished, an official said.

During the action, there was an argument between the nodal officer R S Bath and the Satpal’s family, but it did not stop the demolition.

“The residents of the PG were being extorted of approximately 7,000 rupees per person, and this money was also being used for drug trafficking. On the orders of the chief minister, a joint team of all departments has been formed to carry out this type of action,” Bath said.

Ggm man kills wife for refusing to give money for alcohol, held

GURUGRAM: A man allegedly strangled his wife to death after she refused to give him money for alcohol and tried to pass it off as a natural death, but was arrested after a post-mortem revealed the cause, police said Tuesday.

The police said that on May 2 they received information from a hospital that a woman, identified as Mamta Devi (41), a resident of Saraswati Enclave, was brought dead to the facility.

Her husband, Hari Gopal Sharma, had told police that he had briefly stepped out of the house and upon returning around 5.30 pm he found his wife unconscious.

Sharma alleged before leaving he asked Mamta about her health and she told him that she was fine, they said. The police initiated proceedings under Section 194 of the BNSS and sent the body for autopsy. The accused had initially tried to mislead investigators by claiming that his wife died due to low blood pressure or a heart attack, but a post-mortem examination on May 3 confirmed death by strangulation.

Subsequently, a murder case was registered at Sector 10 police station and the accused was taken into custody.

WATER SHORTAGES REPORTED IN SEVERAL FACILITIES

‘Night shelters struggle to keep cool as heatwave exposes gaps’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A field survey of night shelters in the national capital has flagged serious gaps in heatwave preparedness under the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board’s (DUSIB) Summer Action Plan, with nearly half of the cooling infrastructure found non-functional and water shortages reported across several facilities.

The assessment, conducted by the Centre for Holistic Development (CHD) -- a Delhi-based NGO -- on April 24-25, covered 24 shelters across areas such as Sarai Kale Khan, Jama Masjid, Bangla Sahib, and Mori Gate. The report is titled ‘Field survey report on the assessment of the DUSIB Summer Action Plan 2026-27.’

“Around 50 per cent of cooling units, including fans and desert coolers, were not working, raising concerns as temperatures continue to rise,” the report states.

A senior DUSIB official, speaking on condition of anonymity, said the report has made “unverified claims” and that the situation was “not that dire”.

TAKEAWAYS

- » The assessment, conducted by the Centre for Holistic Development -- a Delhi-based NGO, covered 24 shelters across areas such as Sarai Kale Khan, Jama Masjid, Bangla Sahib. It is titled ‘Field survey report on the assessment of the DUSIB Summer Action Plan 2026-27.’

“The data is not factually correct. Our summer action plan 2026-27 is scheduled to commence on May 15. We have set a deadline of May 10 to correct discrepancies,” he said.

“We agree that there are a few lapses in a few of the night shelters, but they are of a minor nature, and they are being worked upon,” the official said.

At some locations, however, conditions appeared more severe. A shelter at Lahori Gate reported most of its fans and coolers lying defunct, while another at Sarai Kale Khan had no functional coolers. Frequent power tripping at certain



- » Around 50 per cent of cooling units, including fans and desert coolers, were not working, raising concerns as temperatures continue to rise: Report

shelters worsened conditions, making it difficult to operate any equipment that remained operational.

According to the report, access to drinking water also emerged as a major concern, with about 40 per cent of the surveyed shelters lacking permanent water connections. Several facilities were dependent on tanker supply that arrived only once every two days.

“Shortage of basic medical supplies such as oral rehydration salts (ORS) was also reported at multiple locations,” the report states.

The report claimed two

suspected heat-related deaths during the survey period and noted widespread instances of dehydration and skin infections among shelter residents amid limited medical outreach.

The report also highlighted gaps in awareness among staff, with many caretakers unaware of helpline services and mobile applications meant for emergency response and rescue of homeless people.

In a case study cited in the report, a 35-year-old man found in distress near a shelter near Bangla Sahib Gurudwara in central Delhi allegedly did not receive timely medical assistance despite repeated calls for help. He was eventually taken to the hospital only after police intervention, pointing to lapses in coordination between shelter staff and emergency services.

The organisation has urged immediate steps to repair cooling systems, ensure a reliable water supply, provide essential medical kits, and strengthen emergency response mechanisms, warning that delays could put vulnerable homeless populations at greater risk during the ongoing heat wave.

Hail, storms cool city; AQI hits cleanest level this year

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Coming on the heels of a period marked by searing heat, hailstones on Tuesday battered parts of the national capital along with thunderstorms, leading to a sharp drop in temperatures and the cleanest air of the year in the city.

Several areas, including Dwarka and the IGI Airport, experienced intense hail showers, catching residents off guard, yet bringing much-needed respite from the summer heat. The AQI remained in the ‘satisfactory’ category for the second consecutive day.

In terms of rainfall, Palam recorded 9.8 mm between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm, followed by Ayanagar at 1.4 mm, while Safdarjung recorded only trace rainfall and Lodi Road and Ridge reported none during this period.

Till 8.30 am, Ridge recorded 11.9 mm rainfall, followed by Lodi Road at 6.1 mm and Safdarjung at 4.6 mm, while Palam recorded only trace rainfall and Ayanagar reported none.

The city remains under a yellow alert, with the weather department forecasting rain and thunderstorms in isolated areas later in the evening and night. The national



capital recorded below-normal maximum temperatures across all major weather stations, with Safdarjung logging a high of 33.6 degrees Celsius, 5.7 degrees below normal, while Palam recorded 32.8 degrees Celsius, 7.3 degrees below normal.

Lodi Road registered a maximum of 32.2 degrees Celsius, 5.8 degrees below normal, Ridge 32.8 degrees Celsius, 7.2 degrees below normal, and Ayanagar logged 32.8 degrees Celsius, 8.0 degrees below normal.

Minimum temperatures also remained below seasonal averages at most stations, with Safdarjung recording 19.6 degrees Celsius, 5.1 degrees below normal.

Palam logged a minimum of 21.1 degrees Celsius, 4.5 degrees below normal, while Lodi Road recorded 18.6

degrees Celsius, 4.4 degrees below normal. Ridge saw a sharper dip at 17.7 degrees Celsius, 7.3 degrees below normal, and Ayanagar reported 22.4 degrees Celsius, 1.2 degrees below normal.

Mahesh Palawat, vice president of Skymet, said “A fresh western disturbance has been influencing the region in the past few days, leading to a cyclonic circulation over adjoining areas. Light rain might occur in parts of the city tonight and there is less possibility of heatwave at least for the next one week.”

Meanwhile, the city recorded its cleanest May day in three years as the Air Quality Index (AQI) settled at 86 in the ‘satisfactory’ category, according to the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB).

“Delhi records its lowest daily average AQI of the current year today with average AQI clocking 86 at 4.00 pm,” CAQM said in a post on X.

Following overnight showers and a cloudy morning, with hail and rain returning in the afternoon, the AQI improved from 88 recorded a day earlier, which was also in the ‘satisfactory’ category.

According to data from CREA, the previous lowest AQI recorded in May in recent years was 85 on May 31, 2023.

India remains top remittance...

Continued from Page 1

Trajectory over more than a decade, with remittances rising from 53.48 billion dollars in 2010 to 68.91 billion dollars in 2015, 83.15 billion dollars in 2020 and reaching 137.67 billion dollars in 2024.

South Asia recorded the fastest growth in remittance inflows in 2024 at 11.8 per cent, driven largely by sustained transfers to India, Pakistan and Bangladesh. The report notes that high-income countries continue to be the primary sources of these flows. The United States retained its position as the largest remittance-sending country, with outflows exceeding 100 billion dollars, followed by Saudi Arabia with over 46 billion dollars, Switzerland with around 40 billion dollars and Germany with nearly 24 billion dollars.

Migration patterns themselves remain expansive. As of mid-2024, approximately 304 million people were living outside their country of birth, accounting for 3.7 per cent of the global population. This marks a gradual rise from 2.9 per cent in 1990, indicating steady but moderate growth in global mobility. India features prominently in several of the world's largest migration

corridors. The India–United Arab Emirates route ranks as the fifth-largest globally, driven largely by labour migration. The report estimates that more than eight million international migrants reside in the UAE, forming about 74 per cent of its population, with Indians accounting for over three million, the largest nationality group. The India–United States corridor ranks sixth globally and is the second largest involving North America after the Mexico–United States route. In the United States, around 3.2 million Indian migrants were living in 2024, making them the second largest foreign-born group after Mexicans. Other estimates place the broader Indian diaspora in the US at around five million. The report notes that Indian migrants in the US are often highly skilled workers or students, contributing significantly to sectors such as technology and research. The broader global ranking of migration corridors remains led by Mexico to the United States, with about 11 million people. Afghanistan to Iran follows with over 3.7 million migrants, and Syria to Türkiye with more than 3.5 million, largely consisting of refugees displaced by conflict. The Russia–Ukraine

corridor ranks fourth.

The report also highlights the role of diasporas beyond economic contributions. Indian communities abroad have been active in political engagement, particularly in the United States. Organisations such as the United States–India Political Action Committee have influenced bilateral ties, including trade agreements, defence cooperation and visa policies. According to the report, Indian-origin communities have contributed to shaping policy conversations that affect both countries.

Labour migration trends continue to shape demographic patterns. In Gulf countries such as the United Arab Emirates, Saudi Arabia and Kuwait, male migrants significantly outnumber female migrants, reflecting demand in sectors like construction, manufacturing and agriculture. India is among the countries with a high proportion of male emigrants, alongside Bangladesh, Pakistan, Myanmar and Indonesia. In contrast, India itself has a higher share of female immigrants.

Education remains another major dimension of migration. Asia continues to account for the largest share of internationally mobile students. In 2022, China

was the leading country of origin with more than one million students abroad, followed by India with over 620,000. Beyond these two, numbers drop sharply, with countries such as Uzbekistan, Viet Nam and Germany contributing smaller but notable shares. More than half of all international students are based in Europe and North America. The report links migration closely with development, particularly through the role of skilled workers and diaspora networks. It notes that India has sought to convert potential “brain drain” into “brain gain” through initiatives such as diaspora conventions and innovation hubs aimed at reconnecting overseas professionals with domestic opportunities. These efforts are intended to facilitate knowledge exchange, mentorship and investment, though outcomes vary.

Internal displacement within countries also forms a significant part of the migration landscape. In Asia, disasters rather than conflict were the main drivers of displacement in 2024. The Philippines recorded nearly nine million disaster-related displacements, the highest in the region and second globally, with 86 per cent linked to typhoons. India recorded the

second highest figure in Asia, with more than five million displacements caused by floods and storms, including major cyclones. China followed with over 3.9 million displacements, largely due to severe weather events such as Typhoon Yagi. Other regional patterns include migration flows linked to Oceania. All five of the largest migration corridors involving Oceania are directed towards Australia, with the United Kingdom to Australia corridor being the largest, involving just over one million people. Migration from India and China to Australia also ranks among the top corridors. Australia also hosted a significant number of displaced people in 2024, with nearly 30,000 refugees and more than 91,000 asylum-seekers. Many of these asylum-seekers originated from Asian countries, including India and China. Taken together, the findings underscore India's central position in global migration systems, spanning financial flows, labour mobility, education and diaspora engagement. The scale of remittances, the size of migrant populations and the breadth of migration corridors reflect the country's deep integration into global economic and social networks.

Tripura: BJP councillor dies by suicide after being threatened by youths

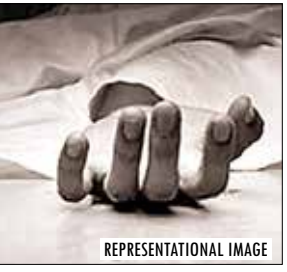
OUR CORRESPONDENT

AGARTALA: A BJP councillor of Dharmanagar Municipal Council (DMC) in North Tripura died by suicide on Tuesday after he was allegedly threatened and humiliated by a group of youth following the saffron party's victory in the Dharmanagar bypoll, police said.

Rahul Kishore Roy, who was also the BJP's Yuva Morcha mandal president, took the extreme step a day after BJP candidate Jahar Chakraborti won the bypoll for the Dharmanagar Assembly constituency by a massive margin.

Chief Minister Manik Saha expressed shock over the youth leader's death and assured an impartial inquiry into the allegations brought by the deceased's wife, Ananya Bhattacharjee.

“I am shocked by the untimely death of Rahul Kishore Roy. May his soul rest in peace, and also offer my sympathy to the bereaved family. I also assured that an impartial inquiry will be conducted



Chief Minister Manik Saha expressed shock over the youth leader's death and assured an impartial inquiry into the allegations brought by the deceased's wife, Ananya Bhattacharjee

following the complaint of the deceased's wife”, the CM wrote on Facebook.

Roy's wife has lodged a complaint with the local police

station, holding seven persons responsible for her husband's death.

“Soon after the announcement of the results of the bypoll to the Dharmanagar Assembly bypoll, six to seven youths attacked our residence at Chandrapur at 3 pm and started hurling abuses at my husband. They also assaulted me to hand over my husband to them,” she stated in the complaint.

Ananya said, “The same gang returned late at night again, attacked our house and hurled two or three bombs. They also threatened to eliminate my husband whenever he is found at Dharmanagar.”

Deeply upset by the attacks and threats, my husband committed suicide by hanging from the ceiling early Tuesday morning. I urge the Officer in Charge (OC), Dharmanagar police station, to investigate against these people for justice, she said.

“Based on a specific complaint, we have registered a case, and an investigation is underway. No one has been arrested yet,” SP, North Tripura, Avinash Kumar Rai said.

UP: Man drowns in Gomti river; 13-yr-old boy saves three teens in Sultanpur

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SULTANPUR: A 23-year-old man drowned while bathing in the Gomti river in Sultanpur district on Tuesday, while a 13-year-old boy displayed remarkable courage to rescue three other teenagers from drowning, police said.

The deceased has been identified as Kuldeep, a resident of Arjunpur Belhari village under Gosainganj police station limits.

According to police, Kuldeep had gone to the river along with three boys -- Manjeet (15), Kallu (13) and Om Lal (15) -- to catch fish. The four later entered the river to bathe but accidentally moved into deep waters and began to drown.

At that time, Rajkumar (13), who was grazing buffaloes nearby, noticed them struggling in the water. He rushed to their aid and managed to

rescue Manjeet, Kallu and Om Lal after sustained efforts, officials said.

However, Kuldeep could not be saved due to his heavier build, they added.

SHO Akhand Dev Mishra said that upon receiving information, Sub-Divisional Magistrate of Jaisinghpur Prabhakar Singh and Tehsildar Mayank Mishra reached the spot.

With the help of local divers, Kuldeep's body was recovered from the river and sent for post-mortem after completing legal formalities.

Police said Kuldeep was a labourer and the youngest among six siblings. His parents had passed away earlier.

Following the incident, Jaisinghpur Block Pramukh Rahul Shukla visited the village, met the bereaved family and expressed condolences. He also provided financial assistance to Rajkumar and honoured his mother.

Jammu–Srinagar Vande Bharat Express draws over 16,300 passengers in first 4 days

JAMMU: The newly launched Vande Bharat Express service between Jammu and Srinagar has witnessed an enthusiastic response from travellers, with 16,349 passengers availing the service in the first four days, railway officials said on Tuesday.

Launched on May 2, the semi-high-speed train has recorded an average occupancy of around 82 per cent during this period, reflecting its growing popularity among commuters for both speed and premium onboard services.

“Overall, analysing the occupancy statistics from May 2 to 5, approximately 16,349 passengers enjoyed their journey, and the average occupancy rate stood at about 82 per cent,” officials said.

They said a steady surge in daily passenger volume has been observed on the route.

On May 4, the train recorded an occupancy of 82 per cent, with around 4,680



Vande Bharat Express en route to Srinagar from Jammu as it commences regular service for the general public, in Jammu

PTI

passengers travelling in two pairs of trains.

The occupancy further jumped to 96 per cent on May 5, when only a single pair of trains -- Nos 26404 and 26403 -- was operational due to the weekly schedule. Around 2,744 passengers travelled on each side that day.

The increasing footfall indicates that tourists and pilgrims are preferring the modern travel experience in Vande Bharat Express over the conventional train services, officials said.

They said the passengers also appreciated the train's world-class amenities, includ-

ing its smooth and jerk-free ride on the winding tracks, along with the quality of food served onboard.

Authorities from the Jammu division have been conducting regular inspections to ensure high service standards, they added.

Senior Divisional Commercial Manager Uchit Singhal said the service is reflective of the ongoing modernisation of Indian Railways and has been well received by passengers.

“The surge in occupancy from 82 to 96 per cent within two days is a matter of immense pride. We are glad that passengers are satisfied and are considering this train a reliable travel option,” he said.

Singhal said passengers' feedback is being closely monitored to further enhance the travel experience. “With the tourism season picking up, we expect the train to achieve near full occupancy in the coming days,” he said.

AGENCIES

Self-proclaimed healer rapes 13-year-old girl in Palghar, arrested

PALGHAR: A 55-year-old self-proclaimed healer allegedly raped a 13-year-old tribal girl in a forest area in Maharashtra's Palghar district, where he took her under the pretext of obtaining a medicinal plant for her treatment, police said on Tuesday.

The incident occurred in the wee hours of Monday and the accused, a resident of a village in Vikramgad taluka of the district, was arrested at around 4 am on Tuesday, they said.

A complaint in this connection was lodged by the elder sister of the victim, inspector Amar Patil of the Kasa police station said.

The complainant said she and her sister approached the accused on April 30 to seek herbal treatment for the latter's irregular menstrual cycle. The man was known among villagers as a healer who provided herbal treatment to patients, he said.

“On May 3, the accused visited the residence of the victim. Under the pretext of procuring a medicinal plant for her treatment, he took the complainant, her 19-year-old sister and some of their relatives in a car,” Patil said.

The group departed from Dahanu around 11.30 pm. After driving a short distance, the accused parked the vehicle by the roadside near Charipawan around 1 am. He lured the teenage victim to accompany him into the nearby bushes under the guise of gathering the medicinal plant and instructed other passengers to remain inside the vehicle, the inspector said.

“Once in the secluded forest area, the accused raped the minor girl and subsequently threatened her with dire consequences if she disclosed the incident to anyone,” the inspector said, citing the complaint.

AGENCIES

From Page 1

BJP govt to take

election rally in Barrackpore on April 27 -- the last day of campaigning, hinted that he will attend the swearing-in if BJP comes to power.

“This is my last rally in this election. I'm going back with the confidence that I will definitely attend the BJP's swearing-in ceremony after the May 4 results. And that only increases my enthusiasm,” he had said.

The chief minister and the new Cabinet are expected to take the oath in West Bengal on May 9. The decision to appoint Union Home minister Amit Shah as observer was aimed at ensuring a smooth government formation process after Mamata Banerjee declined to resign. He will also oversee the election of the BJP legislative party leader.

The oath-taking ceremony at Kolkata's Brigade Parade Ground, following the BJP's sweeping victory, is more than a logistical choice—it carries a charged political message, steeped in history, symbolism, and the shifting electoral tide in West Bengal.

Mamata

that the outcome had been engineered in favour of the BJP with the help of the Election Commission and other Central agencies. “They have looted at least 100 seats,” the TMC supremo alleged.

Addressing a Press conference at her Kalighat residence alongside senior party leaders, Banerjee also announced the formation of a 12-member fact-finding committee to investigate incidents of post-poll violence. The committee, divided into three teams of four members each, will visit the homes of party workers and TMC offices allegedly vandal-

ised by BJP supporters.

Escalating her attack, Banerjee reiterated her allegations of intimidation during the counting process. “They kicked me in the belly. Threw me out of the counting centre. The CCTV cameras were off. The CRPF personnel were acting like goons,” she claimed.

Banerjee alleged that the counting process in her Constituency, Bhowanipore, as well as in several other constituencies, was disrupted by BJP agents while security personnel remained passive. “I was leading by around 30,000 votes, with about five rounds left. We should have crossed 32,000 when the BJP candidate entered and stopped the counting,” she said. She further alleged that BJP members entered counting centres and assaulted counting agents.

She also claimed to have seen a message from a District Election Officer 15 days earlier stating, “Counting mein khela hoga” (“The game will be on counting day”), which she said pointed to foul play by the Election Commission.

Banerjee further hinted at a broader political resistance against the BJP, saying leaders of the INDIA alliance had reached out to express solidarity. “Sonia ji, Rahul Gandhi, Arvind Kejriwal, Uddhav Thackeray, Akhilesh Yadav, Tejashwi Yadav, Hemant Soren called me. All our INDIA alliance partners have assured me of their support,” she said.

TMC national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee echoed a similar stance, asserting that the party did not accept the outcome as a genuine public mandate.

PM condemns attacks

peace, stability and global energy security.”

The Ministry of External Affairs also issued a response, calling the incident unacceptable. Spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said India was urging “immediate

cessation of these hostilities and the targeting of civilian infrastructure and innocent civilians.”

He reiterated India's longstanding position that dialogue remains essential to restoring calm in West Asia. “We also call for free and unimpeded navigation and commerce through the Strait of Hormuz in keeping with international law. India stands ready to support all efforts for a peaceful resolution of issues,” he said.

The Strait of Hormuz remains a critical global chokepoint, with nearly one-fifth of the world's oil and gas passing through it. Disruptions to shipping in the narrow waterway have already pushed up oil prices and led to energy shortages in several countries.

According to the UAE's defence ministry, its air defence systems intercepted 12 ballistic missiles, three cruise missiles and four drones launched during the attack. The ministry said it “remains fully prepared and ready to deal with any threats.”

The UAE's foreign ministry described the strikes as a “dangerous escalation” threatening the country's security and stability. Meanwhile, Iranian media reported that Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi is scheduled to visit Beijing on Tuesday as part of ongoing diplomatic outreach.

Tamil Nadu

Secular Progressive Alliance, said Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) has sent feelers seeking the grand old party's support in government formation.

On a day of fast moving developments, Vijay staked claim to form the government informing Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar, that the party had secured 108 seats, and being the single largest, it should be invited to form the government.

“We request an opportunity to demonstrate our majority,” Vijay had said in an e-mail communication to the governor, a source in the TVK said.

“The decision on extending support to TVK will be made by the Congress high command,” a Congress senior leader said and indicated that many in the TNCC unit wanted a berth for the party MLAs.

The opposition AIADMK won 47 seats while its allies the PMK obtained four and the BJP and AMMK clinched one seat each in the election, according to the data available on the Election Commission of India's website.

CPI (M) state secretary P Shanmugam told reporters that it was for the TVK to respond if it could prove its majority.

DMDK general secretary Premalatha Vijayakanth, another ally of the DMK, said she would continue the poll ties with the DMK and extended her wishes to Vijay on government formation.

Meanwhile, the TVK thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi for lauding the party for its impressive performance in Assembly polls.

“The well-being of our people remains our only goal. Transcending politics, we shall focus on the state's progress and the welfare of people of Tamil Nadu. We look forward to the Union Government's support in this endeavor,” TVK said on ‘X’.

CM race intensifies

Kerala in-charge Deepa Das Munshi, will hold discussions with party MLAs.

They are expected to meet MLAs individually, sources said. They are also likely to meet leaders of alliance partners, including the IUML.

After that, the Congress Parliamentary Party will meet and pass a one-line resolution authorising the AICC to take a decision on the next Chief Minister, sources said.

At the same time, the CPI(M)-led LDF, which suffered a huge setback in the election, will discuss the reasons for the rout of the

front after 10 years in power in the state.

Pinarayi Vijayan, who resigned as Chief Minister following the defeat, has not spoken to the media yet.

Vijayan, who was in Kan-nur when the election results were announced, has left for Thiruvananthapuram.

Kerala on Monday witnessed a sharp political reset as the state electors voted out the last Left government in the country, bringing back the Congress to the ruling saddle after a gap of 10 years, while the BJP broke through a long-standing electoral drought by winning three seats.

Apart from strong anti-incumbency against the government, the results of the April 9 polls also indicated a consolidation of support across sections of society in favour of the United Democratic Front, which had been in opposition to the Left dispensation for the past decade.

The UDF won 102 seats, while the CPI(M)-headed LDF netted 35 seats, according to Election Commission data on counting of votes for 140 constituencies.

The outcome also marked the absence of the Left from governance in any Indian state for the first time in five decades. The ire against the government was so strong that 13 ministers in the cabinet suffered defeat in the political tsunami unleashed by the UDF.

Not only the Congress, but its key allies, including the IUML, the Kerala Congress also secured massive victory in the polls, which saw the complete erasure of the LDF in some key districts.

Govt clears Rs 18,100 cr

support continued operations, safeguard employment and maintain supply chains. The government added that the credit guarantee would enable banks and financial institutions to meet additional working capital needs

of eligible borrowers.

The scheme offers 100 per cent credit guarantee coverage for MSMEs and 90 per cent for non-MSMEs and airlines, to be provided by the National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Limited to lending institutions. This backing is aimed at covering defaults on additional credit extended to businesses facing short-term liquidity gaps.

Loan terms differ by sector. For airlines, the tenure is set at seven years from the date of first disbursement, including a two-year moratorium period. For MSMEs and non-MSMEs, loans will carry a five-year tenure with a one-year moratorium.

The scheme will apply to loans sanctioned from the date guidelines are issued by the National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Limited until March 31, 2027.

Civil Aviation Minister K Rammoan Naidu described the move as critical for the aviation industry. In a post on X, he said the scheme would help airlines manage liquidity pressures while maintaining operations amid global disruptions. He added that it would support job protection, connectivity and overall resilience in the sector.

Both MSMEs and airlines have faced financial challenges since the West Asia conflict began in February. The ECLGS was originally introduced in May 2020 to cushion economic impact during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Cabinet clears

The last revision in the court's capacity came in 2019, when the number of judges was increased from 30 to 33, excluding the Chief Justice of India. Over the decades, the strength of the apex court has been expanded multiple times through amendments to the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956.

Originally, the 1956 law capped the number of judges, excluding the CJI, at 10. This was

raised to 13 in 1960 and later to 17. A significant expansion followed in 1986, taking the number to 25, and another amendment in 2009 increased it to 30. The 2019 revision further enhanced the strength to 33.

The process for increasing the number of judges typically begins with a recommendation from the Chief Justice of India to the Union Law Minister. After consultations with the Finance Ministry, the Department of Justice prepares a draft bill for Cabinet approval.

Under Article 124 of the Constitution of India, a Supreme Court judge must be an Indian citizen and meet criteria such as serving as a high court judge for at least five years, practising as an advocate for 10 years, or being recognised as a distinguished jurist.

Scooter catches fire outside BSF headquarters in Jalandhar

CHANDIGARH: A scooter parked near BSF Chowk in Punjab's Jalandhar district caught fire on Tuesday evening causing panic in the area, police said, even as locals claimed they heard a blast-like sound from the vehicle.

The incident took place at around 8 pm outside the headquarters of the Border Security Force's Punjab Frontier, which is located along a road that connects the main city with the Amritsar-Delhi highway.

Nobody was hurt, said police who have cordoned off the area. It is yet to be ascertained how the scooter caught fire, they said, even as opposition parties launched an attack on the AAP government over an “explosion” in Jalandhar.

AGENCIES

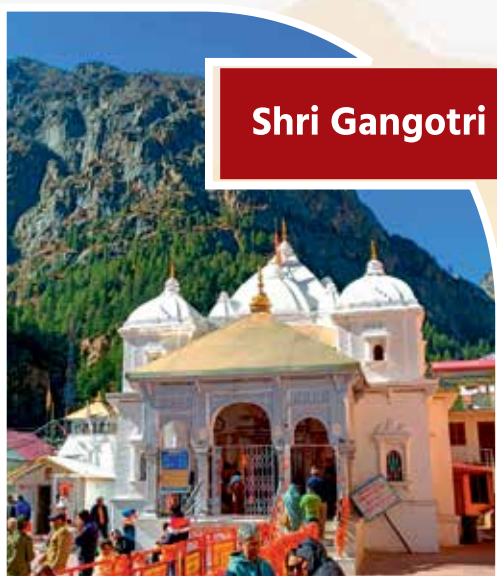


Uttarakhand
GAURAV, VIKAS AUR SANKALP KA PARV

Shri Yamunotri



Shri Gangotri



Shri Kedarnath



Shri Badrinath



SPIRITUAL AND NATURAL ATTRACTIONS NEAR THE CHAR DHAM ROUTE

Near Yamunotri

Janki Chatti & Hanuman Chatti, Kharsali Village, Saptarishi Kund, Lakhamandal, Kedarkantha Trek, Rana Chatti.

Near Kedarnath

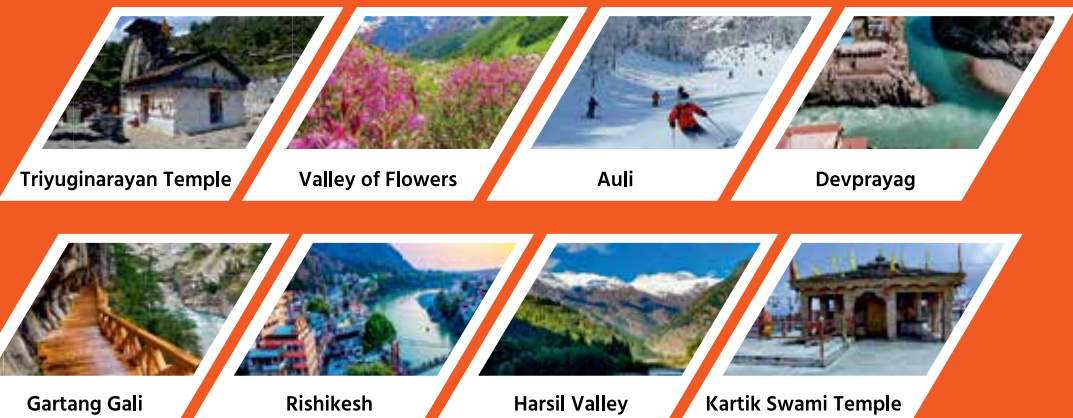
Bhairavnath Temple, Vasuki Tal, Gaurikund, Triyuginarayan Temple, Chopta - Tungnath - Chandra Shila, Deoria Tal.

Near Gangotri

Gaumukh Trek, Bhojbasa & Tapovan, Surya Kund & Gauri Kund, Harsil Valley, Mukhimath (Mukhba), Dayara Bugyal Trek, Gartang Gali, Kashi Vishwanath Temple (Uttarkashi), Nachiketa Tal & Dodital.

Near Badrinath

Mana Village, Vyas Gufa & Ganesh Gufa, Bhimsila, Auli, Valley of Flowers, Vasudhara Falls, Charanpaduka, Tapt Kund & Narad Kund, Jyotirmath (Joshimath), Satopanth Lake, Pandukeshwar, Adibadri Temple, Hemkund Sahib.



“The Honourable Prime Minister has termed the third decade of the 21st century as the 'Decade of Uttarakhand.' In line with the Prime Minister's vision, we are working with an 'unwavering commitment' (Vikalp Rahit Sankalp) to make the state an ideal state in every field.”

Pushkar Singh Dhami
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand

Important Information

Mandatory Registration: Registration is compulsory before commencing the Yatra.

Verify Contact Details: Please ensure you enter the correct mobile number during registration.

Be Prepared for Weather: Carry adequate woolen clothes, an umbrella, and a raincoat.

Accurate Health Data: Provide precise health information during the registration process.

Senior Citizen Advisory: Senior citizens are advised to undergo a medical check-up before starting the journey.

Medication: If you are on prescribed medication, carry a sufficient stock of your medicines.

Acclimatisation: Take frequent breaks at various transit points along the route to acclimatize to the high-altitude climate.

Health First: If you feel unwell, please do not proceed with the journey.

Beware of Scams: Avoid unauthorised individuals claiming to facilitate 'Darshan' at the shrines.

Keep Tracks Clean: Cooperate with us in keeping the pilgrimage routes clean; do not litter.

Safe Driving: Maintain controlled vehicle speed and park only in designated parking areas.

No Plastic: Strictly avoid the use of single-use plastic.

Modes of Registration

Visit the website or scan the QR Code:
registrationandtouristcare.uk.gov.in



Download the App
touristcareuttarakhand



FOR ANY ASSISTANCE,
PLEASE CONTACT OUR 24X7
TOLL FREE NUMBER:
0135-3520100

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT

PHONE:

0135-2552627

0135-2559898

E-MAIL:

touristcare.uttarakhand@gmail.com

#ExploreUttarakhand



@DIPR_UK

Devbhoomi
Uttarakhand
VIKAS BHI, VIRASAT BHI

Chardham Yatra

A WARM WELCOME TO ALL DEVOTEES



My dear Countrymen,

The sacred Chardham Yatra has commenced in the holy land of Devbhoomi Uttarakhand. This divine pilgrimage to the four shrines, including the darshan of Baba Kedar, is a magnificent celebration of India's eternal (Sanatan) cultural consciousness. Jagadguru Adi Shankaracharya gave a new direction to Indian culture through his pilgrimages to Badrinath and Kedarnath. Similarly, Jagadguru Ramanujacharya and Jagadguru Madhvacharya also visited Badrinath to enrich their spiritual philosophies.

Even today, these four shrines nestled in the lap of the Himalayas remain divine centers of our eternal faith and belief. Every year, people belonging to diverse languages, traditions, and cultures come here, further strengthening the spirit of 'Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat'. This year's Yatra is an extension of that very tradition.

Our scriptures state:

अग्निष्टोमदिभिर्यज्ञैरिष्टा विपुलदक्षिणेः।
न तत्फलमवाप्नोति तीर्थार्थिभिर्मननैः यत्॥

Meaning: The immense merit (Punya) earned through grand Yagyas (sacrificial rituals) and charity is profound. However, the merit obtained through a pilgrimage (Tirtha Yatra) is even greater than that gained through those rituals.

In the resolve for a 'Viksit Bharat' (Developed India), the role of a 'Viksit Uttarakhand' is extremely vital. A few years ago, at the gateway of Baba Kedar, I had said that this decade would be the 'Decade of Uttarakhand.' Today, the progress of Uttarakhand is turning that belief into reality. Uttarakhand is setting new benchmarks in all three sectors: tourism, spirituality, and economic growth.

The great ritual of development (Vikas ka Mahayagya) that has been underway in Uttarakhand for the past few years has made the Chardham Yatra more accessible, safer, and divine than ever before. This is providing great convenience to the visiting devotees, saints, and tourists. In all these efforts, every care is being taken to preserve the natural beauty of Uttarakhand.

I would also urge every guest visiting Uttarakhand to truly enjoy this new experience. During your journey, I encourage all travellers to observe a "Digital Fast" and strive to live within the natural beauty of Uttarakhand. This will provide you with a unique sense of satisfaction.

Historically, we have always traveled from our homes to Devbhoomi for the Chardham Yatra with a specific resolve. In this spirit, I wish to urge you to take Five Resolves (Panch Sankalp):

First Resolve – Cleanliness is Paramount: Maintain cleanliness within and around the shrines. Contribute your part to keeping the rivers clean. Take a pledge for a journey free of single-use plastic and uphold the dignity of this sacred land.

Second Resolve – Sensitivity towards Nature and Environment: Be sensitive toward this divine Himalayan land. While maintaining the balance of nature, contribute to environmental conservation through initiatives like 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' (A Tree in Mother's Name).

Third Resolve – Emphasis on Service, Cooperation, and Unity: Since ancient times, our pilgrimages have been a medium for universal service and social harmony. Even today, people serve pilgrims with this same spirit. I urge every pilgrim visiting the Chardham to perform at least one act of service every day of their journey. Help your fellow travellers and connect with people coming from different parts of the country. By participating in their traditions, strengthen the spirit of 'Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat' through this pilgrimage.

Fourth Resolve – Promoting 'Vocal for Local': From the time you leave your home until you return, ensure that you spend at least five percent of your total travel budget on purchasing local products. Even if a local item is not immediately needed in this season, try to buy it for future use.

Fifth Resolve – Adherence to Discipline, Safety, and Decorum: Follow the rules of the journey and traffic instructions. As a responsible and alert citizen, make this pilgrimage safe and accessible. Let us ensure that our journey does not cause any inconvenience to the people involved in the organisation and management of this Yatra.

In recent years, a large number of creators and influencers have started visiting the Chardham. I urge all of you to make an effort to share the local stories of Uttarakhand and its small, unique traditions with the masses.

May the blessings of Baba Kedar and all the four shrines infuse your life with new energy, new inspiration, and new resolutions. This is my wish for you.

My heartiest best wishes to all of you for a successful, safe, divine, and soulful journey.

Yours

Narendra Modi



Panch Kedar

1. Kedarnath
2. Tungnath
3. Rudranath
4. Madhmaheshwar
5. Kalpeswar

Panch Prayag

1. Devprayag
2. Rudraprayag
3. Karnprayag
4. Nandprayag
5. Vishnuprayag

Panch Badri

1. Vishal Badri
2. Yogdarshan Badri
3. Bhavya Badri
4. Vradha Badri
5. Aadi Badri

Use only the official portal
for Helicopter Bookings
To Avoid any Fraud
www.heliyatra.irttc.co.in

During the Chardham Yatra, you can also visit and experience the divine Panch Kedar, Panch Prayag and Panch Badri. In the Panch Badri, Lord Vishnu is worshipped in various unique forms

BJP's 4.6 percentage points rise in vote share results in gain of 22 seats

Assam: 126-member Assembly to have 7 women MLAs; six of them from NDA

SP steps up pressure on BJP over women's reservation ahead of 2027 UP polls

Mann meets Prez seeking cancellation of 6 MPs' RS membership, says it's 'murder' of Constitution

Kerala polls: BJP came second in 6 constituencies

He also increased the party's vote share in the constituency as compared to the 2021 Assembly polls. In 2021, the BJP came third with 16.25 per cent of the votes, while this time it got 30.61 per cent of the votes. **MPOSH**

Big win empowers BJP to recast Assam politics

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, का कार्यालय, रॉली
झापांक.-3508 / र0का0, रॉली दिनांक :-04.05.2026
अति आवश्यक सूचना

एतद द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि रॉली जिलाबल के निलंबित आरक्षी / 1347 अजय कुमार भगत प0 बटेखा भगत , ग्राम सातो नावाटोली प0-सातो थाना विशुनपुर जिला गुमला, झारखण्ड दिनांक 26.08.2017 से बिना किसी सूचना / अनुमति या अवकाश के अपने कर्तव्य से फरार हो गये हैं। जिस आरोप में रॉली जिला वि0कार्य0 सं0 176 / 2017 संचालित किया गया है। निलंबित आरक्षी श्री भगत को घर के पता पर पुलिस पदाधिकारी भेजकर कर्तव्य पर उपस्थित होने एवं अपना बचाव स्पष्टीकरण समर्पित करने हेतु पत्र हस्तागत कराया गया है। कर्तव्य पर उपस्थित होने एवं अपना बचाव स्पष्टीकरण समर्पित करने हेतु पूर्व में भी समाचार पत्र के माध्यम से प्रकाशित कराया गया है। उसके बावजूद भी न तो अपना बचाव स्पष्टीकरण समर्पित किये न ही अभी तक अपने कर्तव्य पर उपस्थित हुए हैं।

आप को पुनः समाचार पत्र के माध्यम से सूचित किया जाता है कि 15 दिनों के अन्दर अपने कर्तव्य पर उपस्थित हों अन्यथा संचालित वि0का0 में एकतरफा निर्णय ले लिया जायेगा।

**वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक,
रॉली**

Rangasamy set for fifth term as Pondy CM, Cong wins one seat

chi (LJK), other NDA constituents, emerged successful from one seat each and the combine has 18 seats in the 30-member



EDITORIAL
MIGRATION
EQUATION

The movement of people across borders has always been a quiet indicator of how the world works. Trade flows may reveal economic priorities, and diplomacy may signal political intent, but migration reflects something more fundamental: where opportunity lies, where security is found, and where aspirations can take shape. The latest findings of the International Organization for Migration in its World Migration Report 2026 offer a revealing snapshot of this reality. India's presence in two of the world's largest migration corridors—towards the United Arab Emirates and the United States—underscores not just the scale of its diaspora, but the evolving character of its engagement with the global economy.

At one level, the numbers are striking. More than 304 million people now live outside their country of birth, a figure that has grown steadily, if not dramatically, over the decades. Yet what is more telling is the persistence of certain migration pathways. The India-UAE corridor, largely composed of migrant workers, reflects a long-standing pattern of labour mobility shaped by economic demand in the Gulf. The India-United States corridor, by contrast, is driven by skilled professionals and students, pointing to a very different kind of economic relationship. Together, these corridors capture a duality that defines India's global footprint: it is both a supplier of labour to the world and a source of talent that fuels innovation in advanced economies.

This duality, however, raises important questions. Migration is often discussed in terms of remittances and economic gain, but its implications are far more complex. For millions of Indian workers in the Gulf, migration is tied to livelihood, often under conditions that remain precarious despite improvements over time. The concentration of male migrants in sectors such as construction and manufacturing reflects not only demand patterns but also the limited pathways available for more diversified or secure employment. In contrast, Indian migrants in the United States occupy a different economic space altogether, contributing to sectors such as technology, healthcare and academia. This divergence is not merely economic; it is structural, highlighting disparities in opportunity, access and long-term security.

For India, the challenge is to reconcile these two realities. The country benefits significantly from its diaspora, both in terms of remittances and influence. Remittance inflows remain among the highest in the world, providing critical support to households and contributing to macroeconomic stability. At the same time, the Indian diaspora—particularly in countries like the United States—has emerged as an important bridge in shaping bilateral relations. Organisations such as the United States-India Political Action Committee (USINPAC) illustrate how diaspora communities can influence policy, strengthen strategic partnerships and deepen economic ties. Migration, in this sense, is no longer a one-way movement; it is part of a broader network of engagement that connects economies, institutions and societies.

Yet, there is a risk in viewing migration solely through the lens of benefit. The steady rise in outward migration also reflects gaps within the domestic economy. When large numbers of working-age individuals seek opportunities abroad, it raises questions about job creation, wage levels and the capacity of the domestic market to absorb talent. This is particularly relevant in the context of skilled migration to countries like the United States. While the success of Indian professionals abroad is often celebrated, it also points to the persistent challenge of retaining high-skilled talent within India. The so-called "brain drain" may have evolved into a more nuanced "brain circulation," but the underlying issue of creating comparable opportunities at home remains.

The gender dimension of migration adds another layer of complexity. The predominance of male migrants from India, especially in labour corridors to the Gulf, reflects deeply embedded socio-economic patterns. It also has implications for families, communities and the broader social fabric. While female migration has grown in some sectors, it remains uneven, often constrained by both demand conditions and social norms. Addressing this imbalance requires not only economic reform but also a broader rethinking of how mobility is structured and supported.

In a changing global context, migration is also becoming more closely linked to geopolitics. As countries reassess their economic dependencies and tighten controls over labour and technology flows, the conditions under which migration takes place are likely to shift. Visa regimes, labour protections and recognition of skills are increasingly shaped by strategic considerations. For India, this makes it essential to engage more actively in shaping the rules that govern mobility. Bilateral agreements, skill partnerships and stronger consular support systems will be critical in ensuring that migration remains a source of strength rather than vulnerability.

Ultimately, the significance of India's position in global migration corridors lies not just in scale, but in what it reveals about the country's trajectory. Migration is both an outcome and a driver of economic change. It reflects where India stands today, and where it is headed. The task before policymakers is to move beyond a passive acceptance of these patterns and towards a more strategic approach—one that enhances the benefits of migration while addressing its underlying challenges.

The world is becoming more interconnected, but also more uncertain. In this environment, the movement of people will continue to shape economic and political outcomes in profound ways. For India, the question is not whether migration will remain central to its global engagement—it undoubtedly will. The real question is whether it can harness this mobility to build a more resilient, equitable and forward-looking economy at home, while strengthening its position in an increasingly competitive world.

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS
CHAIRPERSON
BHARAT KI SOCH

Chandragupta
Maurya's life
offers enduring
lessons in
discipline,
mentorship,
institution-building,
strategic restraint
and the moral
limits of authority

Power, when pursued only for personal elevation, rarely leaves behind moral memory. But power shaped by discipline, counsel and purpose can become an instrument of civilisational consolidation. In the life of Chandragupta Maurya, Bharat's civilisational memory preserves not merely the story of an emperor, but the journey of a young man who rose through adversity, accepted guidance, built institutions and eventually understood that authority too must remain subordinate to duty. His life speaks not only to rulers and administrators, but to every individual who seeks to transform difficulty into direction, ambition into responsibility and success into service.

Chandragupta Maurya, founder of the Mauryan Empire, ruled for 24 years, from 321 BCE to 297 BCE (according to the testimony of the Puranas and the Buddhists). He emerged at a time when internal political decay (declining kingdoms like the Nandas) coincided with external disruption (Greek incursions and instability after Alexander). This unique convergence allowed him, guided by Chanakya, to dismantle existing powers and establish the Mauryan Empire that was one of the earliest and most powerful models of political unity and administrative order. There are many lessons to be learnt from his journey and I would like to share a few that had the greatest impact on me.

The first of these lessons is that greatness is seldom born in comfort. It is formed through endurance, correction and the willingness to be shaped by demanding circumstances. For the young professionals, leaders and institutions, this lesson carries enduring relevance. One's origin or circumstances are not the final measure of one's capacity. A life of meaning begins when the individual refuses to surrender to limitation and instead converts difficulty into inner resolve and becomes worthy of responsibility before claiming authority.

At the centre of this transformation stands Chanakya, also remembered as Kautilya, one of the most formidable minds in Indian political thought. The relationship between Chandragupta and Chanakya is not merely a tale of strategy alone. It is a deeper example of mentorship, discipline and the shaping of raw potential. Chandragupta possessed courage and ambition, but Chanakya gave these qualities direction, structure and purpose. In this relationship lies a timeless lesson that talent without guidance can become scattered, while wise counsel gives ambition a moral and strategic framework. No leader, however gifted, grows in isolation. The willing-



From empire to renunciation, Maurya's legacy reminds us that power is not an end, but a responsibility to be outgrown

ness to learn, to listen, to be corrected and to submit personal impulse to disciplined training is itself a mark of strength.

This has clear relevance for modern life. In families, institutions, public service and corporate environments, mentorship remains one of the most valued sources of transformation. A capable person may rise quickly, but without wise counsel, that ascent can lose direction. The mind that refuses correction eventually becomes captive to its own self-interest. Ethical leadership begins with the humility to recognise that knowledge and perspective before they can be exercised.

The fall of the Nanda dynasty, often perceived as oppressive due to heavy taxation and centralised power structures, and the rise of the Mauryan, assumes special relevance when understood through the lens of responsibility. Chandragupta's achievement was not simply that he defeated an existing order that was flawed, but that he helped establish a new one. This distinction is important. Destruction alone is never leadership. True leadership lies in the capacity to replace instability with order, fear with confidence and fragmentation with coherence. In this sense, Chandragupta's life teaches that power becomes ethical and meaningful only when it serves a purpose larger than personal victory.

Power Shaped by Discipline

From adversity to empire and finally renunciation, Chandragupta's journey reminds us that true leadership is measured not by conquest alone, but by purpose, humility and legacy

Authority must create security, justice, administration and continuity. Without these, success remains incomplete.

His leadership also demonstrates the moral value of disciplined courage. Courage is often imagined as bold action in moments of danger, but Chandragupta's life suggests a more mature understanding. Courage also lies in waiting, preparing, learning and choosing the right moment. It lies in accepting hardship without losing direction and facing well-entrenched forces without surrendering to intimidation. Anger can never be a strategy and impatience is not strength. This kind of courage is essential in every age and situation. Leaders are often judged by speed, visibility and forcefulness, but enduring leadership requires composure. The ability to act decisively must be balanced by the wisdom to act at the right time and for the right reason.

Perhaps Chandragupta's greatest leadership lesson lies in institution-building. He is remembered not merely because he rose to power in adverse circumstances, but because he helped establish one of the most significant imperial structures in Indian history. The Mauryan achievement was not limited to conquest. It involved administration, organisation, governance, economic management, security and political integration. This is where his example becomes especially relevant to modern leadership. A true leader does not build only around himself. He builds systems that outlast him. Personal charisma may create excitement, but institutions create continuity. Personal success may win admiration, but institutional strength creates legacy.

This distinction matters deeply in contemporary corporate life. Individuals may seek recognition but a legacy is created by committing oneself to building processes, teams, structures and cultures that endure beyond their presence. Chandragupta's example reminds us that leadership should not become personality-driven. It must mature into architecture. The test of leadership is not only what happens while the leader is present, but what remains functional, ethical and stable when he is absent. In this lies the difference between temporary dominance and lasting contribution.

Chandragupta's engagement with the wider world also reflects strategic maturity. The political environment during this period was complex. The north-western frontier required both reinforcing and diplomatic management. Seleucus I Nicator, a former general under Alexander, became one of the Diadochi (successors) and founded the Seleucid Empire, stretch-

ing from Syria to parts of Central Asia. Chandragupta's dealings with him are often remembered as an example of realism in statecraft. The two entered into a Treaty of remarkable pragmatism, even exchanging envoys, and avoided conflict. The lesson here is not merely strategic success, but the ability to convert conflict into settlement and uncertainty into advantage. Mature leadership does not confuse aggression with strength. It understands when to resist, when to negotiate and when to transform confrontation into a durable order.

Yet the most profound moral lesson from Chandragupta's life may come not from his rise, but from the way tradition remembers his final years. In his later years, Chandragupta Maurya is widely believed to have turned toward asceticism and spiritual renunciation, most strongly associated with the Jain tradition. Whether approached as history, tradition or civilisational memory, this final movement gives his life a rare completeness. The same figure who acquired immense power is remembered also for stepping away from it. This introduces a deep Indian understanding of greatness. Power is not the highest end of life. It must eventually be measured against inner conquest, detachment and moral accountability.

In this, Chandragupta becomes more than a conqueror. He becomes an example of the full arc of human aspiration that includes struggle, discipline, achievement, service and renunciation. His life teaches that ambition is not wrong when it is disciplined by duty. Strength is not dangerous when it is restrained by ethics. Authority is not corrupting when it remains accountable to a larger moral order. But ambition without restraint, strength without conscience and authority without humility can weaken even the most capable individual.

Chandragupta Maurya offers a complete framework of life and leadership. The lessons drawn here do not capture the full measure of his journey, but they are among the ones that leave the deepest impression. The young must learn to rise above circumstance, the ambitious must seek guidance, the powerful must build institutions, the strategic mind must remain anchored in purpose and the successful must remember that achievement is not the final measure of life. In the end, Chandragupta's enduring relevance lies not only in the empire he built, but in the values his life continues to provide. Discipline before power, duty before ambition, counsel before ego and moral purpose before personal glory.

Views expressed are personal

GLOBAL
RECAST



SHISHIR PRIYADARSHI

THE WRITER IS THE
PRESIDENT OF
CHINTAN RESEARCH
FOUNDATION

The era of
frictionless
global trade is
receding. In its
place is a harder
landscape where
supply chains,
technology
and finance
are instruments
of power

For much of the past three decades, the global economy ran on a simple idea, namely that nothing mattered more than efficiency and the cost of production. Countries produced what they could most efficiently, traded whatever else they needed from the cheapest source, and trusted that global rules would keep the system stable.

Today, that logic is being challenged. Efficiency still matters, but resilience has become just as important. The shift is unmistakable. Economics is no longer just about markets; it is increasingly about power. Trade, technology, and finance are being used not only to create wealth, but to secure strategic advantage. Export controls on rare earth minerals, restrictions on semiconductors, large-scale industrial subsidies in advanced economies, and the growing use of sanctions; all point in the same direction. The vocabulary of globalisation has quietly changed - from openness and efficiency to security and control.

For India, this is not an abstract transformation. It is already shaping everyday economic choices; from access to cutting-edge technologies to the availability of critical minerals needed for the energy transition. As global rules weaken and geopolitical tensions rise, one reality is becoming clear: when rules lose authority, power fills the gap. And countries that rely only on the old model of open, rules-based integration risk being left exposed. Why efficiency alone is no longer enough

If the old model was built on efficiency, the new one is being rebuilt around resilience. Businesses today are no longer asking only, "Where is it cheapest to produce?" but also, "What happens if this supply chain breaks?" Governments, too, are no longer



India's challenge is no longer to merely participate in globalisation, but to shape its direction and terms

content with deep integration; they are seeking buffers against disruption.

India's own experience in recent years illustrates this shift. During the pandemic, disruptions in pharmaceutical supply chains exposed a heavy dependence on Chinese intermediates, even in a sector where India is globally competitive. Similarly, the rapid expansion of electronics manufacturing, boosted by Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes, which offer firms incentives to scale manufacturing in India, still relies significantly on imported components.

To its credit, India has begun to respond. Mobile phone exports have surged, and global firms such as Apple have expanded assembly operations in the country. There is also a push into areas like semiconductors, green hydrogen, and renewable energy manufacturing; sectors that promise deeper value addition.

But resilience is not built through incentives alone. It depends on something more fundamental: trust. For global firms, that means predictable policies, reliable infrastructure, and consistent execution. In other words, resilience is as much about gov-

ernance as it is about economics. Navigating a three-way World

Overlaying these economic shifts is a more complex geopolitical reality; a tripartite kind of reality defined by the United States, China, and the rest of the world. For India, this triangular dynamic is not theoretical; it shapes real economic decisions every day. It is also central to India's economic resilience.

On one hand, India's partnership with the United States has deepened significantly, especially in areas like critical technologies, defence, and digital infrastructure. Initiatives such as the Initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology (ICET) reflect a growing alignment of interests. This is despite pain points in several areas, especially trade and tariffs.

On the other hand, India's economic ties with China remain deeply entrenched. The trade deficit is substantial, and Indian manufacturing continues to depend heavily on Chinese inputs, from electronics components to key pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs). This creates a structural tension. India cannot fully decouple from China without incurring high economic

costs. Nor can it afford to ignore the strategic risks of overdependence. At the same time, aligning too closely with any one partner limits flexibility.

The result is a delicate balancing act, but one that cannot remain purely reactive. The real challenge is to reduce vulnerabilities while expanding options: deepen partnerships where interests align, diversify supply chains where risks are high, and build domestic capabilities where dependence is most acute. In this sense, the question for India has evolved. It is no longer simply about integrating with the global economy, but about staying meaningfully integrated in a world where integration itself is becoming selective and conditional.

From Balancing to shaping

This is where India's opportunity, and its challenges, come into sharper focus. India today is no longer a marginal player. It is large enough to influence markets, increasingly trusted as a partner, and often expected to play a stabilising role in an uncertain world. But this position brings new responsibilities.

At the same time, the global system that once provided predictability is under strain. Dispute resolution mechanisms have weakened, subsidies are rising, and national security is increasingly invoked to justify economic decisions. For a country like India, which has traditionally relied on multilateral rules to protect its interests, this creates both a dilemma and an opening.

The instinctive response might be cautious adaptation—adjusting policies at the margins as global conditions evolve. But that may no longer be enough. What is needed instead is a shift from balancing to shaping.

This means aligning trade, industrial, and technology strat-

egies with a clear objective: not just to participate in global value chains, but to influence how they are structured. It means playing a more active role in setting standards, building coalitions, and shaping supply chain networks. And it means doing so while preserving strategic autonomy—a principle that has long guided India's external engagement.

The risks of not acting decisively are real. In a fast-moving global economy, supply chains that shift away are difficult to bring back. Investment decisions, once made, tend to stick. Incremental reform, in this context, can be as costly as inaction.

From Resilience to Leverage

Ultimately, resilience is not the end goal—it is the foundation. India's challenge is not whether it can stay connected to the global economy. It already is—and will remain so. The deeper question is whether it can convert that connection into leverage.

Leverage comes from capabilities: strong domestic manufacturing, credible institutions, skilled human capital, and the ability to offer scale with reliability. It also comes from strategy—the willingness to align policies, prioritise sectors, and act with clarity in a fragmented world.

The era of effortless globalisation is over. In its place is a more contested, more uncertain, but also more open-ended system—one where outcomes are shaped as much by choices as by circumstances. For India, this is a moment of consequence. It can continue to adapt to a changing world; or it can help define it. The difference between the two is not just semantic. It is the difference between participation and influence. And in today's global economy, that difference will determine how India will grow in the coming years.

Views expressed are personal

TALKS WITH PM TODAY

India & Vietnam eye enhanced ties; NSA calls on Prez To Lam

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: National Security Advisor Ajit Doval on Tuesday met Vietnamese President To Lam, focusing on boosting the comprehensive strategic partnership between the two countries.

The talks took place hours after Lam arrived in New Delhi on a three-day visit to India. It is his first state visit to the country after being elected as the president this month.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the Vietnamese leader will hold wide-ranging discussion on Wednesday that is expected to explore ways to shore up bilateral ties in areas of trade, defence and critical technologies.

NSA Doval and President Lam exchanged views on "strengthening the multi-faceted comprehensive strategic partnership between the two countries", External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said on 'X'.

Lam looked forward to his meeting with PM Modi and the engagements scheduled over the next two days, he said.

Lam also serves as General Secretary of the Communist Party of Vietnam.

In their talks, the two leaders are also likely to deliberate on the prevailing situation in West Asia and South China Sea, a region that has witnessed increasing Chinese military muscle-flexing.

There have been growing concerns over China's sweeping claims of sovereignty over all of the South China Sea, a huge source of hydrocarbons.

Several countries in the region including Vietnam, the Philippines and Brunei, have



National Security Adviser Ajit Doval with Vietnam President To Lam during a meeting, in New Delhi

HIGHLIGHTS

» NSA Ajit Doval on Tuesday met Vietnamese President To Lam, focusing on boosting the comprehensive strategic partnership

» The talks took place hours after Lam arrived in New Delhi on a three-day visit to India

» It is his first state visit to the country after being elected as the president

this month

» PM Modi and the Vietnamese leader will hold wide-ranging discussion on Wednesday

» Talks are expected to explore ways to shore up bilateral ties in areas of trade, defence and critical technologies

» Lam also serves as General Secretary of the Communist Party of Vietnam

counterclaims.

India and many other democratic countries have been pressing for peaceful settlement of the disputes and for adherence to international law, especially the UNCLOS (UN Convention on the Law of the Sea).

In the talks, the two sides are set to explore ways to boost defence cooperation, especially

in the maritime domain.

Last year, the two sides inked a pact to set up a framework for submarine search, rescue and support mechanism. They also signed a letter of intent to strengthen bilateral defence industry collaboration.

President Droupadi Murmu is also scheduled to meet Lam. The Vietnamese leader will also visit Mumbai.

PIL has become ‘Paisha Interest Litigation’ and ‘Political Interest Litigation’, says SC

NGO grilled for 2006 PIL on entry of women of all ages to Sabarimala temple

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Commenting on the misuse of PILs, the Supreme Court on Tuesday remarked that Public Interest Litigation has now become 'Private Interest Litigation', 'Publicity Interest Litigation', 'Paisha Interest Litigation' and 'Political Interest Litigation'.

This observation came from a nine-judge Constitution bench while they were hearing petitions regarding discrimination against women at religious sites, including the Sabarimala temple in Kerala, as well as the scope of religious freedom across various faiths.

The bench comprised Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justices B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh, Ahsanuddin Amanullah, Aravind Kumar, Augustine George Masih, Prasanna B Varale, R Mahadevan and Joyimalya Bagchi.



The top court questioned the objective of the Indian Young Lawyers Association over its 2006 PIL challenging the prohibition of women aged 10 to 50 from entering the Sabarimala Temple in Kerala.

Advocate Ravi Prakash Gupta, representing the Indian Young Lawyers Association, argued that the PIL was based

This observation came from a nine-judge Constitution bench while they were hearing petitions regarding discrimination against women at religious sites

on four newspaper articles published in June 2006.

In response, the CJI remarked that the PIL should have been dismissed outright. "How does this article give the cause of action to file a PIL? It is easy to get articles written for the sake of filing PILs," the bench said.

Justice Nagarathna added, "We have been entertaining

PILs in High Courts and in the Supreme Court for the general public who need it. Not for articles being written in newspapers.

"Public Interest Litigation has now become Private Interest Litigation, Publicity Interest Litigation, Paisha Interest Litigation and Political Interest Litigation. All are called PILs, but we entertain only real and genuine PILs," she said.

She also noted that the CJI receives hundreds of letters daily, questioning whether they could all be turned into PILs.

The hearing is underway.

A five-judge Constitution bench had lifted the ban preventing women between the ages of 10 and 50 from entering the Sabarimala Ayyappa temple in a 4:1 majority verdict in September 2018, ruling that the centuries-old Hindu religious practice was illegal and unconstitutional.

Vietnam Prez To Lam visits Bihar’s Gaya Ji

GAYA JI (BIHAR): Vietnamese President To Lam, who is on a three-day tour of India, mediated under the sacred Bodhi Tree here and prayed at the Mahabodhi Temple on Tuesday, officials said.

Lam was earlier received at the airport here by Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary and other senior officials.

"The Vietnamese President offered prayers at the UNESCO World Heritage Mahabodhi Temple, meditated beneath the sacred Bodhi Tree, and also visited the Vietnamese monastery," an official said.

"The spiritual, cultural, and heritage city of Gaya Ji warmly honours the arrival of the esteemed President of Vietnam. This historic arrival will undoubtedly take the already deep India-Vietnam relations to new heights," the CM said in a post on X.



President of Vietnam To Lam being received by Bihar CM Samrat Choudhary upon his arrival, in Gaya

Former Bihar legislative assembly speaker Prem Kumar, who represents the Gaya Town constituency, said it was a matter of pride that the Vietnamese President visited "this land of knowledge".

Lam is scheduled to hold wide-ranging discussions with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday, and also meet President Droupadi Murmu in the national capital.

NEW DELHI: Most of the Congress candidates who won in the recent Assembly elections in Assam, Kerala, West Bengal and Tamil Nadu were Muslims, sources analysing the poll results said.

As per the results, 18 out of 19 MLAs that Congress has won in Assam are Muslims. The Congress had fielded 20 Muslim candidates in Assam, of whom 18 won, while only one non-Muslim won the elections, out of the 79 non-Muslims fielded by the party.

Congress ally Rajgor Dal has won two seats, out of which one is a Muslim and the other is Akhil Gogoi, who is under investigation by the NIA for alleged links with Maoists, the sources said.

Kerala has elected 35 Muslim MLAs in an assembly of

As per the results, 18 out of 19 MLAs that Congress has won in Assam are Muslims

140. Out of these 35, as many as 30 are from the Congress-led UDF alliance. Eight Congress MLAs are Muslims and the other 22 of its ally, the Indian Union Muslim League MLAs, are Muslims.

The grand old party won two seats in West Bengal -- both of whom are Muslims from Muslim-dominated seats. In fact, with 63 Muslim candidates, the Congress outdid the TMC in giving tickets to Muslims in West Bengal. The TMC gave tickets to 47 Mus-

lim candidates in the assembly elections.

In Tamil Nadu, Congress nominated two Muslims, of whom one has won. Muslims fielded by Congress alliances in both Kerala and Assam have an 80 per cent winning strike rate, the sources said.

The BJP on Monday scripted history by winning 206 seats to secure more than a two-thirds majority in the West Bengal assembly polls, ending the TMC's 15-year rule.

The ruling NDA is set to form the government in Assam for the third consecutive term after securing a two-thirds majority, with a record high of 102 seats in the 126-member assembly, while the Congress-led Opposition delivered its worst performance in recent times.

AGENCIES

Ludhiana becomes 3rd Punjab city to adopt ITMS: DGP

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: In yet another major step towards modernising the Punjab, Ludhiana has become the third city in the state, after Jalandhar and Mohali, to implement the Intelligent Traffic Management System (ITMS), announced Director General of Police (DGP) Punjab Gaurav Yadav as he inaugurates the futuristic Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC) here on Tuesday.

The DGP highlighted that under the ICCC project as many as 1,700 high-resolution cameras have been installed at 259 locations to strengthen the city's surveillance grid.

The ITMS, which has been installed at 46 locations across the city, can detect upto nine traffic violations including red light violation, stop line violation, driving without helmet, pillion rider without helmet, triple riding, overspeeding, zebra crossing violation, wrong side driving and wrong parking.

DGP Gaurav Yadav, who was in Ludhiana as part of ground-zero tour, termed the upgraded state-of-the-art ICCC a major step towards preventive policing.

"The newly inaugurated ICCC integrates multiple units under one roof, including Traffic, Police Control Room (PCR), Safe City, and Wireless units, which has significantly enhanced synergy and coordination in police working and reduced PCR response time from 15 minutes to just 7/8 minutes," he said.

The DGP, accompanied by Commissioner of Police (CP) Ludhiana Swapan Sharma and Deputy Inspector General of Police (DIG) Ludhiana Range Satinder Singh, also held a comprehensive meeting with field officers, emphasising swift and citizen-centric resolution of public grievances.

Haryana: Saini flags off special train to Takhat Sri Hazur Sahib

KURUKSHETRA: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday flagged off a special pilgrimage train to Takhat Sachkhand Sri Hazur Sahib in Maharashtra's Nanded.

Addressing a function under the Mukhyamantri Teerth Darshan Yojana at Kurukshetra Railway Station, the Chief Minister flagged off a special pilgrimage train to Takhat Sachkhand Sri Hazur Sahib and interacted with the pilgrims, conveying his best wishes for a safe and spiritually enriching journey.

Providing details of the pilgrimage, he informed that more than 800 pilgrims from nine districts are undertaking the journey, with comprehensive arrangements made for their safety, security, food and overall comfort.



Highlighting the spiritual significance of the initiative, Saini said that the special train serves as a symbolic bridge between Kurukshetra, the land where Lord Krishna delivered the message of the Bhagavad Gita, and Takhat Sachkhand Sri Hazur Sahib, the sacred site where Guru Gobind Singh attained 'Joti Jo'.

He said this initiative reflects the continuous and vibrant flow of India's spiritual

traditions.

He also announced that a grand Somnath Yatra will be organised from the state on June 8, stating that the Somnath Temple stands as a symbol of India's eternal faith, rich cultural heritage and the resurgence of national self-respect.

Referring to the Centre's initiative, he said that under the "Somnath Swabhimaan Parv", a year-long national commemoration will be observed till January 11, 2027.

In a separate programme, Saini also addressed a seminar and exhibition on the theme "Empowered Women, Empowered Nation", jointly organised by Kurukshetra University and the Information, Public Relations and Languages Department at Kurukshetra University.

MPOST

Nutritional support to 2.8 mn TB patients could avert 120,000 deaths yearly in India, says study

‘Undernutrition isn’t just a complication of tuberculosis -- it’s one of its root causes’

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Providing food baskets to 2.8 million people with tuberculosis in India could avert over 120,000 deaths yearly, according to a study.

"For less than the cost of many biomedical interventions, we could prevent over 100,000 TB (tuberculosis) deaths a year," senior author Pranay Sinha, assistant professor of medicine at the US' Boston University's school of medicine and an infectious disease physician at the Boston Medical Center, said.

Researchers in collaboration with India's National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme (NTEP) found that food support is a cost-effective way to improve health outcomes for people with TB in 94 per cent of the study's simulations. The findings are published in the British Medical Journal (BMJ) Global Health.

Undernutrition could be the single greatest modifiable risk factor for TB, contributing to immune suppression, treat-

KEY POINTS

» Researchers in collaboration with NTEP found that food support is a cost-effective way to improve health outcomes for people with TB in 94 per cent of the study's simulations

» The findings are published in the British Medical Journal (BMJ) Global Health

» Undernutrition could be the single greatest modifiable risk factor for TB, contributing to immune suppression, treatment failure, and death, the researchers said



» In 2020, the Revised National TB Control Programme (RNTCP) was renamed as NTEP, aimed at eliminating the bacterial infectious disease in India

ment failure, and death, the researchers said.

"Undernutrition isn't just a complication of TB -- it's one of its root causes. While we wait for effective vaccines for TB, food is the vaccine we already have, and providing food baskets to households affected by TB could be one of the most impactful things we do for TB elimination," Urvashi Singh, former Deputy Director General of the NTEP, said.

In 2020, the Revised National TB Control Programme (RNTCP) was renamed as NTEP, aimed at eliminating the bacterial infectious disease in India.

The study compared standard care with a household-level nutritional food-basket intervention. The researchers also looked at previously published studies, including systematic reviews.

"Nutritional support was

projected to avert 10, 470 DALYs (years of poor health) per 10,000 PWTB (persons with TB). When scaled to India's 2.8 million annual TB cases, this corresponds to approximately 120,120 TB deaths averted nationwide under full coverage," the authors wrote.

Each of the health gains would cost an estimated USD 141, which the researchers said is well below India's benchmark of USD 550 and suggests that

the intervention could be a good investment.

"What this study shows is that scaling up in-kind nutritional support in India isn't just the right thing to do -- it's also an excellent investment," Sinha said.

First author Julia Gallini, a doctoral candidate in biostatistics at Boston University, said, "This work bridges the gap between clinical evidence and policy. We wanted to give NTEP and global health policymakers a clear, quantitative picture of what nutritional support could achieve nationally. The numbers make a compelling case."

An August 2023 study, published in The Lancet journal, showed that nutritional support with proteins and multivitamins reduced new TB cases by nearly half among family members of patients in India.

The RATIONS trial enrolled household contacts of 2,800 patients with confirmed tuberculosis across 28 TB units of the NTEP in four districts of Jharkhand.

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh government has withdrawn the mandatory use of prepaid smart meters for electricity consumers and decided to revert to a postpaid billing system, a move expected to benefit lakhs of users across the state.

Under the revised arrangement, all electricity connections will function in postpaid mode, allowing consumers to pay their bills after usage as per the earlier system. Officials said monthly billing will resume, with consumers getting a 15-day window to clear dues. New electricity connections will continue to be issued with smart meters, but these will operate in postpaid mode. The ongoing drive to replace conventional meters with prepaid smart meters has been halted for now, and around 75 lakh

INSIGHT

» Under the revised arrangement, all electricity connections will function in postpaid mode, allowing consumers to pay their bills after usage as per the earlier system

» Officials said monthly

billing will resume, with consumers getting a 15-day window to clear dues

» The decision follows widespread complaints from consumers over technical glitches, inflated billing and delays in restoring connections despite recharge

connections that had shifted to prepaid mode over the past year will be converted back.

The decision follows widespread complaints from consumers over technical glitches, inflated billing and delays in restoring connections despite recharge. Protests had also been reported from several parts of the state.

Amid growing public discontent, especially during the election period, Chief Min-

ister Yogi Adityanath had set up a high-level committee to review the rollout. Energy Minister A.K. Sharma later announced that smart meters would continue but only in postpaid mode. "The billing cycle will remain similar to the earlier postpaid system. Consumers will receive monthly bills through SMS and WhatsApp and will be given adequate time to make payments," Sharma said.

According to officials, electricity consumption will be calculated from the first to the last day of each month, with bills issued by the 10th. Consumers will have 15 days from the billing date to make payments, with due dates clearly mentioned.

Consumers who do not receive bills can access them through WhatsApp chatbots using their connection number or lodge complaints via the 1912 helpline. Authorities have advised users who have changed their mobile numbers to update their details to continue receiving billing alerts.

In another relief measure, consumers will be allowed to clear pending dues till April 30 in up to 10 instalments. Special camps will be organised at division and sub-division levels in May and June to address grievances related to smart meter billing.

AGENCIES

India’s defence output up 174%, exports jump 34-fold: Jitendra Singh

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India's defence manufacturing and export capabilities have expanded sharply over the past decade, with production rising 174 per cent to Rs 1.54 lakh crore and exports surging 34 times to Rs 23,622 crore, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology Jitendra Singh said on Tuesday.

Speaking at the North Tech Symposium 2026 in Prayagraj, Singh said India is at a transformative stage in its defence trajectory, driven by technological advancement, indigenous innovation and growing private sector involvement. He noted that private industry alone accounted for nearly Rs 15,000 crore in exports, reflecting a shift towards a more collaborative and diversified manufacturing ecosystem.

Highlighting budgetary support, Singh said Rs 6.81 lakh crore has been allocated for defence in the Union Budget 2026-27, a 9.5 per cent increase over the previous year. He emphasised that modern warfare is increasingly

He pointed out that India has made notable strides in quantum-secure communication

shaped by cutting-edge technologies, real-time intelligence and automated systems rather than sheer manpower.

The minister stressed that domains such as space, atomic energy, artificial intelligence and quantum technology are becoming central to defence preparedness. He pointed out that India has made notable strides in quantum-secure communication, a capability expected to play a crucial role in next-generation warfare.

Calling for closer coordination among the Armed Forces, scientific institutions and industry, Singh urged faster transitions from design to deployment, with an emphasis on durability and long-term sustainability. He also highlighted the Armed Forces' vital role in disaster relief and humanitarian missions.

China: 26 dead after blast at fireworks factory

China is a leading manufacturer and exporter of fireworks

BEIJING: At least 26 people were killed and 61 others injured in a massive explosion at a fireworks factory in China's Hunan province, officials said on Tuesday. The explosion occurred on Monday afternoon at the plant operated by the Huasheng fireworks manufacturing and display company in Liuyang, a county-level city under Changsha, the provincial capital.

Videos circulating on Chinese social media showed massive destruction of property spanning several kilometres.

More than 480 rescuers, organised into five teams, have been deployed for relief operations, with three rescue robots pressed into service. Officials said 26 people were killed and 61 others were injured. The injured have been rushed to hospitals for treatment. China is a leading manufacturer and exporter of fireworks. As the explosion site is located near two black powder warehouses, the rescuers have evacuated nearby residents

Key Points

» Videos circulating on Chinese social media showed massive destruction of property spanning several kilometres

» More than 480 rescuers, organised into five teams, have been deployed for relief operations

and set up a buffer zone to prevent a secondary accident, the state-run Xinhua news agency reported. Changsha Mayor Chen Bozhang expressed condolences to the victims and apologised to their families, affected residents and society at large.

"We are deeply grieved and filled with remorse," he said at a press conference, where attendees observed a moment of silence for the victims, Xinhua reported.



GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
PATIALA URBAN PLANNING & DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
PUDA Complex, Urban Estate Phase-II, Patiala
PUBLIC NOTICE

INVITATION OF BIDS FROM EMPANELLED INDEPENDENT VALUERS FOR DETERMINATION OF RESERVE PRICE OF UNSOLD SITES

Patiala Urban Planning and Development Authority (PDA) invites sealed bids from independent valuers empaneled with Nationalized Banks/Income Tax Department in the double envelope system for the valuation of reserve prices of various sites (residential/commercial plots, institutional/industrial sites, etc.) which have remained unsold in the last 2 or more auctions. The Bidder should not have been barred/blacklisted by the concerned Banks/Income Tax Department for any valuation work. The bid for the fees should be quoted per site. PDA shall appoint three (3) independent valuers for each such site to determine the reserve price in accordance with the amended E-Auction Policy dated 16.10.2025. Interested empanelled bidders can obtain the detailed bid document including the list of unsold properties which are to be valued and terms & conditions from the office of the Estate Officer, Patiala Urban Planning and Development Authority, PUDA Complex, Urban Estate, Phase II, Patiala, on any working day during office hours or download the same from the official website <https://www.pdpatalia.in/>

Sealed bids (Technical Bid & Financial) in Separate envelopes complete in all respects along with CV, must reach the office of the Estate Officer, Patiala Urban Planning and Development Authority, PUDA Complex, Urban Estate, Phase II, Patiala-147002, latest by 18.05.2026 by 3 P.M. Technical bids shall be opened on 19.05.2026 at 11:00 A.M and Financial bids shall be opened at 11:30 A.M on the same date in the presence of bidders or their authorized representatives.

The bids should fulfill all criteria mentioned in the detailed bid amount available at the official website <https://www.pdpatalia.in> to be deemed eligible. PDA reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids without assigning any reason therefor. For any queries, contact the Estate Office, PDA at Patiala or email at pdaoffice@puda.gov.in

PR-Advt. No :- 1319/12/2026-27/11193 Estate Officer

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER.
MINOR IRRIGATION DIVISION, Ranchi

e-Procurement Tender Notice
Two Envelope System
Short Tender Reference No:- WRD/MID/04/BD/(SLI)2026-27
PR No.-377041 Minor Irrigation(26-27) D (2nd Call)
Letter no-.....Date-.....

1	Name of Work:	Construction of Mukhyamantri Solar Lift Irrigation Scheme at Patratu Block.- Kanke, Dist.- Ranchi.
2	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs. 1,09,18,500.00
3	Cost of tender document (Rs)	Rs 10,000 only (non-refundable).
4	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Rs 1,10,000.00 only.
5	Time of Completion	335 Days
6	Mode of Submission of tender	Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
7	Date of Publication of Tender on website	Date: 15.05.2026 Time: 2:00 PM
8	Last Date/Time for downloading of bidding documents and Submission of Tender on Website	Date: 21.05.2026 Time: 2:00PM
9	Submission of Tender Fee and EMD	Start Date:-15.05.2026 Time:- 2:00 PM Last Date:- 21.05.2026 Time:- 2:00 PM
10	Technical Bid Opening Date	Date: 22.05.2026 Time: 2:00 PM
11	Officer Inviting Bids	Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation Division, Ranchi
12	Contact No. of Procurement Officer e-mail of Procurement Officer	9431190681
13	Help line No. of Procurement Cell	0651-3512781/Email ID- ecmidran-cemr-jhr@nic.in

Note:-

» Work will be awarded to those bidders {specially MNRE approved channel partners/MNRE approved manufacturers/ MNRE approved PV system integrators/ A registered manufacturers/ Company/ Firm/ Corporation in India (including MSME of Jharkhand) of at least one of the major sub system namely pumps or PV System electronics (confirming to National/ International Standards)/ any other agencies having experience of installation and commissioning of such solar powered irrigation schemes}. Empanelled Indigenous Manufacturers of 10 HP pumps (AC/DC Surface water Pumps) in the department with all accessories for off-grid stand alone SPV water pumping systems can also take part in the bid for executing the whole work of the bid. However those bidders who have not yet registered in Water Resources Department can also submit their bid provided they will have to get themselves registered in Water Resources Department within two months from the date of allotment of work.

» Only E-Tender will be accepted.

Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer,
Minor Irrigation Division,
Ranchi

PR.NO. 379050 Minor Irrigation(26-27):D



To become a partner in the success of the country

GOLDEN OPPORTUNITY

Specific organization of One Station One Product plan

One Station One Product Scheme was announced by the Government of India in the budget of the year 2022-23. In this scheme, with the objective of providing local product under Vocal for Local Vision at all stations of Indian Railways, Policy No. 12 of 2022 dt. 20.05.2022, 15 of 2022 dt. 10.08.2022, 18 of 2022 Dt. 20.09.2022, 09 of 2023 Dt. 24.05.2023 & 29.09.2023 Under this scheme, stalls and show cases are to be provided to local individuals, voluntary organizations, voluntary groups, NGOs etc. North Central Railway also ensured to provide the facility of sales/co-promotion center through stalls/kiosks at following stations under this scheme.

LIST OF STATIONS

Sonbhadra, Mirzapur, Vindhyachal, Chunar, Manikpur, Prayagraj-Chheoki, Fatehpur Kanpur Central, Pankidham, Kanpur Anwarganj, Phaphund, Mainpuri, Hathras, Aligarh, Bhogaon, Aachal, Jhijnhak, Rura, Bharthana, Dadri, Dawar, Etawah, Khurja, Shikohabad Railway stations. **Note:** (1) Out of the above mentioned stations, only after the disposal of the applications of those stations whose applications are still pending in the earlier invited applications, the latest applications received under this advertisement will be considered by the committee in order/priority wise and the received applications will be arranged along with the remaining applications. **The Railway Administration reserves the right to accept or reject any application for any given station as per the requirement without giving any reasons.** (2) Apart from this, it is also to be clarified that for those nominated stations for which applications are not received, the Railway Administration reserves the right to shift/set up the stalls and trolleys available at such stations at other stations of the division at its discretion and to operate the said stalls and trolleys. **Following are the salient features of the scheme:** 1. Under this scheme, the Railway Administration will make and provide stalls/trolleys at the nominated stations. 2. Registration fee and duration of stall/kiosk is for **minimum 15 days** (Registration fees Rs.1000/500) and **maximum 03 months** (Registration fees Rs.6000/3000). 3. Maximum 02 salesmen (including platform vendors) will be authorized to work in each stall in each shift. 4. Electricity charges will be charged on actual basis as per instruction of policy no. 9 of 2023 dt. 24.05.2023. 5. The effective tax liability if any will be of the allottee, for which the Railway Administration will not be responsible. 6. Local products, handicrafts, handooms, local agricultural products, local crafts, processed and semi-processed food items, traditional clothes, wooden or clay articles, toys etc. Or any other products which is not conflict or infringe upon the scope of business of the existing licensee of catering units, Fruit and fruit Juice stalls, milk stalls, Multi Purpose stalls can be sold at OSOP stall.

Interested persons/firms may apply with required documents to Station Superintendent Sonbhadra, Mirzapur, Vindhyachal, Chunar, Manikpur, Prayagraj-Chheoki, Fatehpur, Kanpur Central, Pankidham, Kanpur Anwarganj, Phaphund, Mainpuri, Hathras, Aligarh, Bhogaon, Aachal, Jhijnhak, Rura, Bharthana, Dadri, Dawar, Etawah, Khurja, Shikohabad Railway stations NCR Office upto 12.05.2026.

For any kind of information/Guidance you may contact the following Commercial Inspectors as mentioned below:

S. N.	Station	For any information related to this scheme, Please contact concerned commercial Inspectors	Mobile No.
1.	Aligarh and its section/station	Shri Sanjay Shukla	9794837282
2.	Etawah and its section/station	Shri Nareesh Meena	9794837323
3.	Mirzapur and its section/station	Shri Rajesh Kumar	9794837292
4.	Tundla and its section/station	Shri Manoj Kumar	9794837321
5.	Fatehpur and its section/station	Shri Kapil Dev Meena	9778974526
6.	Khurja & Dadri and its section/station	Shri Hanuman Meena	9794837324
7.	Chunar and its section/station	Shri S. K. Akela	9140712727
8.	Prayagraj Chheoki and its section/station	Shri Omprakash	9794838965
9.	Kanpur Area-2 and its section/station	Shri Lalit Kumar	9616331233
10.	Kanpur Central and its section/station	Shri Dharendra Awasthi	9889203745

For any other information related to this scheme, can contact Shri Arun Chandra Pandey, Commercial Inspector/NFR-1 (Mo. No. 7525001449) & Shri Pankaj Kumar Rajak, Commercial Inspector/NR-II (Mo. No. 7525001455), Divisional Office, Prayagraj and e-mail-cmialddiv@gmail.com.

Note: The selection of participants in the OSOP may be done considering that the benefit of this scheme must reach the marginalized sections. i.e. individuals at the bottom of the pyramid. Priority shall be given to the following:

• Holder of Artisans/weavers ID cards issued by Development Commissioner Handicrafts, Development Commissioner Handlooms, or requisite State/Central Government Authority.

• Individual artisans/weavers/craftsmen enrolled/registered with Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India Ltd. (TRIFED) / National Handloom Development Corporation (NHDC)/Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) etc.

• Self Help Groups registered with PMEGP (Prime Minister Employment Generation Programme).

• Marginalized or Weaker Sections of the Society.

• Priority will also be given to "Divyangjan" in the allotment of OSOP.

• Applications for seasonal fruits will not be accepted at stations where fruit and juice stalls are operational.

Note:- In case of food items, it is mandatory for the applicant to have a valid food license.



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Mobility is our Hallmark

North central railways

@CPRONCR

@northcentralrailway

www.nct.indianrailways.gov.in

996/26 FA

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Karan Singh @ Kishu S/o Ram Shankar R/o BR-105, Indra Vikash Colony, Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 928/23, U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Mahendra Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Karan Singh @ Kishu** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Karan Singh @ Kishu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Karan Singh @ Kishu of FIR No. 928/23, U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Mahendra Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **08.06.2026 at 10:00 am**.

By Order,
Ms. Amardeep Kaur
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North, Room No.117
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/5827/NW/2026(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Notice for Shortlisting of BIS approved Packaged Drinking Water

For and on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Delhi Division, Northern Railway invites applications in the prescribed form from manufacturers/suppliers of reputed brands of BIS approved Packaged Drinking Water (PDW) for inclusion in the list of approved/shortlisted brands for sale/supply at catering establishments over Delhi Division, Northern Railway.

Applications for shortlisting can be submitted in the office of Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi during working hours between **10:00 hrs to 17:00 hrs on any working day up to 29.05.2026 (17:00 hrs)**.

These applications will be considered for primary shortlisting and the shortlisting shall remain valid as per terms and conditions of the notification.

Detailed notification, eligibility criteria, terms & conditions and application form are available on Northern Railway website i.e. www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in.

Any corrigendum/modification, if any, shall be available on the aforesaid website only. 1499/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

NOTICE

To All Interested Bidder's in Construction Tender of N.Rly.

Northern Railway Construction Organization has been assigned to execute the project works of "**Delhi-Ambala 3rd & 4th line (194 km) and "3rd & 4th line between GZB-MB-RAC-SPC (403km)"**. In this regard, Chief Administrative Officer/ Const./ Northern Railway, Kashmir Gate, Delhi is intending to plan a bidders/contractors meet with Civil, Electrical & S&T Contractors at **11:30 Hrs on 14.05.2026** in the office of Northern Railway Construction HQ, Church Road, Kashmir Gate, Delhi-06.

All interested & prospective bidders & contractors are requested to attend the above interaction physically or virtually for giving valuable suggestions for implementation and packaging of the above projects. The online VC link is as under:-
<https://railnet70.webex.com/join/railnet70?MTID=m7fdf4f570505705e9a31b791973a174>

Thursday, May 14, 2026 11:30 AM | 5 hours 30 minutes | (UTC+05:30) Chennai, Kolkata, Mumbai, New Delhi

Meeting number: 2510 869 7982

Password: 123456 (123456 when dialing from a phone or video system)

Join by video system

Dial 25108697982@railnet70.webex.com

You can also dial 210.4.202.4 and enter your meeting number.

Join by phone: +65-6703-6949 Singapore Toll

Access code: 251 086 97982

Dy. Chief Engineer/C/T&C for Chief Administrative Officer/Const.

No.: 74-W-CAO-C-SEMINAR/T&C Dated: 05.05.2026 1500/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

The Sr.DME/Diesel, Northern Railway, Diesel Loco Shed, Tughlakabad for and on behalf of President of India invites e-tenders for the following work. The tender will be accepted online only in the prescribed tender document.

Subject	Description
Name of Work	"Retro-fitment of Air Conditioning in cabs with provision of Thermal insulation of cabs in electric locomotive."
Place of work	Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-110044
Completion Period	02 Years
Approximate cost of work	Rs.2,03,08,382.21/- including GST @ 18% (Rupees Two Crore Three Lakh Eight Thousand Three Hundred Eighty Two and Twenty One Paisa only including GST@18%)
Amount of Bid Security	Rs. 4,06,200/- (Rs. Four Lakh Six Thousand Two Hundred only)
Technical & Financial Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document
Financial Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document
Similar Nature of work	"Repair/Overhauling/Maintenance/Dismantling/Cleaning of any Equipment/M&P in any Shed/Depot/Workshop of Indian Railway/Metro"
Website to download and upload e-tender document	www.ireps.gov.in
Due date & time of uploading of Tender by tenderer	25.05.2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.
Date & Time of Tender opening	25.05.2026 after 12:00 Hrs.
Validity of offer	60 days from opening of tender
Allocation	PH-21

Tender Document can be downloaded from Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in For details of work experience, scope of work and terms & conditions please see Tender document.

Tender Notice No: TKD-Retrofit-AC-RSP26 Date: 02.05.2026 1487/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Amit S/o Om Prakash R/o H.No. R-3/A-3, 51/2, Sainik Enclave, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 381/2020 U/s 33/38/58 Delhi Excise Act.**, has been registered at **P.S. Mundka, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said, **Amit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Amit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Amit of FIR No. 381/2020 U/s 33/38/58 Delhi Excise Act.**, registered at **P.S. Mundka, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.06.2026**.

By Order
Mr. Gaurav Singal
Ld. JMFC-6 (West), Room No. 355
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/5902/OD/2026 (Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Sehdev @ Ajay S/o: Mukesh, R/o: Jhuggi No. B-195, Chuna Bhatti, Kirti Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case No. 739/2020, U/s: 380 IPC, PS: Keshav Puram, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Sehdev @ Ajay**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Sehdev @ Ajay**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Sehdev @ Ajay, of Case No. 739/2020, U/s: 380 IPC, PS: Keshav Puram, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.10.2026**.

By Order
Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04 (N.W)
Room No. 112 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/5880/NW/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Karan@Rishi@Nepali S/o Raghubir Singh Rawat R/o H. No. D-14/185, Sector-08, Rohini Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 272/2022 U/S 392/34 IPC PS: Kashmir Gate, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Karan@Rishi@Nepali** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Karan@Rishi@Nepali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Karan@Rishi@Nepali** accused of (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 272/2022 U/S 392/34 IPC PS: Kashmir Gate, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.06.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
JMFC-11, Room No. 138, First Floor
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/5927/N/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Salman @ Danish S/o Kabir R/o H. No. A-261, Gali No.21, Shri Ram Colony, Khajuri Khas, Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 584/2018, U/S 324/34 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Salman @ Danish** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Salman @ Danish** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Salman @ Danish of FIR No. 584/2018, U/S 324/34 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **10.06.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North East District, Room No.22, 1st Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/5814/NE/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rahul S/o Munna Singh Thakur R/o A-1/44, Gali No.14, Khajuri Khas, Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 163/2022, U/S 380/411 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rahul** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rahul of FIR No. 163/2022, U/S 380/411 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **09.06.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North East District, Room No.22, 1st Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/5811/NE/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Adil, S/o Aneesh, R/o Z-11, 206, Welcome, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 327/2016, U/s 392/34 IPC, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Adil** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Adil** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Adil** accused of **FIR No. 327/2016, U/s 392/34 IPC, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.06.2026**.

By Order - **Ms. Deepakshi Rana**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Shahdara District, Room No. 19, 1st Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/5887/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd. Juber S/o Nurul Haq R/o B-450, Gali No.19, Shri Ram Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 514/2017 U/S 448/380/411 IPC, PS Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Juber** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohd. Juber** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohd. Juber of FIR No. 514/2017 U/S 448/380/411 IPC, PS Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **11.06.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class- 03
Room No. 22, 1st Floor, North-East District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/5841/NE/2026(Court Matter)

Capital gains for CSK

Samson stands out on tricky track as CSK demolish Delhi Capitals

NEW DELHI: Sanju Samson paced his unbeaten 87 off 52 balls perfectly on a tricky track as Chennai Super Kings kept themselves relevant in the Indian Premier League with an eight-wicket win over a self-destructing Delhi Capitals here on Tuesday.

After opting to bat, DC's struggles with the bat at home continued as they ended with a below par 155 for seven on a pitch offering assistance to the spinners with odd ball holding up.

Samson and Kartik Sharma (41 not out off 31 balls) forged a 114-run unbroken partnership off 66 balls for the third wicket, taking CSK home in 17.3 overs for their fifth win of the season. For DC, the road to play-offs got a lot tougher with their sixth loss in 10 matches.

While the CSK spin duo of Akeal Hosein and Noor Ahmad excelled, DC's lead spinner Kuldeep Yadav conceded 34 runs in his three overs. He was hit for four sixes in those 18 balls, releasing all the pressure DC had put on the opposition by limiting them to 44 for one in the powerplay.

While skipper Axar Patel did the containing job well, Kuldeep failed to get a wicket in the middle overs to make it easier for CSK. Trump card



CSK's Sanju Samson paced his unbeaten 87 off 52 balls beautifully PTI

Mitchell Starc was not able to strike early on though Lungi Ngidi removed Ruturaj Gaikwad in his opening over.

It seemed Samson had it all figured out in his head. Having laboured to 15 off his first 17 balls, he targeted Kuldeep post

the powerplay to anchor the chase for his team. His innings included half a dozen sixes.

The opener has also struck two hundreds in his debut season for the storied franchise.

Earlier, DC's free fall began with the loss of opener Pathum

Nissanka who failed to clear the mid-on fielder off a slower ball from left-arm pacer Mukesh Choudhary.

Both Nissanka (19 off 15 balls) and K L Rahul (12 off 13 balls) began with crisp boundaries but did not last long. After Nissanka, Rahul attempted an inside-out hit off left-arm spinner Akeal Hosein but could not get to the pitch of the ball on the charge to be caught by opposition captain Ruturaj Gaikwad.

DC laboured to 37 for two in the powerplay with Hosein bowling half of the overs, including one from the other end that produced the wicket of Rahul.

With DC's innings not gaining any momentum, the crowd, mostly in yellow supporting CSK and M S Dhoni, who did not even travel for the game, built more pressure on the 'home team'. Chants of 'CSK, CSK' were heard regularly during the innings.

With a poor batting performance like that, it seemed DC had not overcome the mental demons of 75 all out in their last game here. After the powerplay, another spinner Noor Ahmad dominated the opposition, removing Karun Nair and Nitish Rana, who both fell to a sweep shot.

Haddin backs Arshdeep

HYDERABAD: Arshdeep Singh might be having an inconsistent run in this IPL, but Punjab Kings' assistant coach Brad Haddin wants the "world-class" left-arm pacer to be at his very best for the "important games at the back end of the tournament."

With 13 points, last year's finalists Punjab Kings are leading the table even as their impressive campaign this year has been jarred by two consecutive defeats.

Haddin said Arshdeep, who has so far taken 10 wickets in nine matches, understands his role well. "Arshdeep is world-class. You know in this tournament there's going to be bad days with how explosive the batting has been right through," Haddin told reporters. "Numbers say that there have been some phenomenal chases, and Arshdeep understands the flow of tournament."

PUNJAB'S TOP ORDER HAS FALTERED

Batting woes haunt Punjab Kings ahead of SRH challenge

HYDERABAD: Punjab Kings batters will be under pressure to halt a worrying slide when they face a confident Sunrisers Hyderabad in the Indian Premier League here on Wednesday.

Punjab, which had emerged as the team to beat with six wins on the trot, stumbled in the last two matches and both the defeats exposed frailties they would be keen to address swiftly.

Despite leading the standings with 13 points from nine games, the margin for error has narrowed considerably, with Royal Challengers Bengaluru, Sunrisers Hyderabad, Rajasthan Royals and Gujarat Titans all within touching distance, just a point behind.

Punjab's recent dip can largely be attributed to a loss of rhythm. Their explosive performances with the bat had covered up for an inconsistent bowling unit much of the season, but the cracks have now begun to show.

The top order, which set the tempo in the early phase, has faltered.

The aggressive approach by the young trio of Priyansh Arya, Prabhsimran Singh and Cooper Connolly has veered into recklessness, resulting in early setbacks and leaving the



SRH's players during a practice session on Tuesday PFI

Punjab stumbled in the last two matches and both the defeats exposed frailties

middle order with repair work.

That middle order, in turn, has struggled to stitch together meaningful partnerships, often relying on individual brilliance rather than collective rebuilding, leading to sub-par totals and faltering chases.

The bowling unit, Punjab's weak link throughout the season, has offered little respite.

Even in victories, the bowlers have allowed opposition batters to score freely in phases, and their lack of discipline at

crucial junctures has made closing out innings a persistent problem.

With the tournament entering a tighter phase, Punjab will require sharper execution and clearer plans, particularly against a formidable SRH batting line-up in the batting-friendly conditions at the Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium.

Third-placed Sunrisers, meanwhile, will be eager to bounce back from a seven-wicket defeat to Kolkata Knight Riders that snapped their five-match winning streak. The loss also cost the Pat Cummins-led side a chance to move to the top of the table.

Their batting, barring contributions from Travis Head and Ishan Kishan, failed to fire in that game.

UCL: Bayern ready for PSG

MUNICH: Bayern Munich have worked their way to within a game of the Champions League final, and players and fans are preparing for an unforgettable moment in Wednesday's semi-final second leg against Paris St Germain, Bayern coach Vincent Kompany said on Tuesday.

The French side, who won the trophy for the first time last year, earned a nail-biting 5-4 victory in the first leg when Bayern battled back from 5-2 down.

Kompany told a press con-

ference there was a feeling among his players and Bayern fans that they were ready to book a spot in the competition's final. "There is this feeling that together we will take the next steps," Kompany said. "Few believed it at the start of the season that we will have a chance with the last home game to reach the Champions League final." "Now we are here, we have experienced great moments and the fans believe we will make it and together we want to make this moment unforgettable." AGENCIES

From lethal to liability? The curious case of the T20 yorker's decline

NEW DELHI: There was a time when the final overs of a T20 contest carried a familiar script. As panic spread through the batting side and the equation tightened, captains would turn to specialists capable of delivering cricket's ultimate pressure-release valve -- the classical yorker.

But in an IPL era increasingly shaped by 220-plus totals, premeditated ramps, reverse scoops and batters willing to stand virtually anywhere on the crease, the delivery that once inspired dread is facing its sternest test.

The question increas-

ingly being asked in dressing rooms and fan discussions is: Has the league's batting revolution killed the yorker? Has the yorker become a high-risk delivery that hapless bowlers prefer to avoid?

Not really. We can hold off on writing the yorker's epitaph, say the pundits. The delivery that once defined an era built by Lasith Malinga and perfected by Bumrah still survives.

Only now, in a batter-dominated age, it demands even greater courage and precision to remain cricket's ultimate finishing weapon. "The yorkers remain an important



IPL's rising totals has put in doubt T20's deadliest delivery PFI

part of the game even though it has become a batter's game," Madan Lal, former India all-rounder, told PFI. "You have to

be very consistent in your line and length for a yorker. You have to hit the lower side of the bat. If it hits slightly higher it is a six. Same with wide yorkers. Your length is key," said Lal, a member of the 1983 World Cup winning squad.

Other experts echo Lal. The consensus view is that while IPL has not killed the yorker, it has exposed the cricketing nuclear option's vulnerabilities, increased the punishment for imperfection and elevated its execution into one of cricket's rarest acts of skill.

What has changed, experts say, is that T20 cricket has

forced the yorker to evolve from a routine death-over option into a specialist skill requiring extraordinary precision.

There was a time when yorkers built reputations and decided championships.

From Lasith Malinga's toe-crushing precision for Mumbai Indians to Dwayne Bravo's slower-yorker variations for Chennai Super Kings and the near-mechanical accuracy of Jasprit Bumrah, the yorker was for years the definitive image of death bowling in the Indian Premier League.

Deep Dasgupta, a former India wicketkeeper-batter and

TV analyst, believes the biggest transformation lies in the changing movement patterns of modern batters.

"The classical toe-crushing yorker that Wasim (Akram) and Waqar (Younis) used to bowl back then were on toes that were static targets because batters didn't have big trigger movement or shuffle in ODIs or Tests," he said.

Death-over run rates have steadily climbed over the years as batters have transformed finishing into a science, using movement and anticipation to convert even marginal errors into boundaries.

World

As US withdraws, Europe sees need for bigger role within NATO

YEREVAN: European leaders said President Donald Trump's surprise decision to pull thousands of US troops out of Germany is just the latest signal that Europe must take more responsibility for its security.

The Pentagon announced last week it would pull some 5,000 troops out of Germany, but Trump told reporters on Saturday the US plans on "cutting a lot further". Trump offered no reason for the move, which blindsided NATO. But his decision came amid an escalating dispute

with German Chancellor Friedrich Merz, who said the US has been humiliated by Iran in talks to end the war it launched with Israel on Feb 28. Trump has also expressed anger over European allies' reluctance to get involved in the conflict.

European leaders meeting at a summit in Yerevan, Armenia, sought to both downplay the impact of 5,000 fewer troops in Germany while acknowledging that it provides a useful nudge for the continent to step up its role within NATO.

ZELENSKY SLAMS MOSCOW'S 'UTTER CYNICISM'

Russian strikes kill 5 in Ukraine right before ceasefire takes hold

KYIV: Russian drone and missile strikes targeting Ukraine's power grid during the night killed at least five people and wounded 39 others, Ukrainian authorities said Tuesday, less than a day before Kyiv said it would enact a ceasefire and three days before Moscow promised its own truce.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy rebuked Moscow for what he said was its "utter cynicism" in launching the attacks after Russia announced a unilateral truce over two days later this week while it marks the 81st anniversary of the defeat of Nazi Germany in World War II.

"Russia could cease fire at any moment, and this would stop the war and our responses," Zelenskyy said in a post on X. "Peace is needed, and real steps are needed to achieve it. Ukraine will act in kind."

The truce proposal follows a familiar pattern of Russia declaring short unilateral ceasefires



Emergency services personnel work to extinguish a fire a vehicle following a Russian drone attack in Kyiv on Tuesday

during the war timed to various holidays — most recently Orthodox Easter — that don't produce any tangible results amid deep

mistrust between Moscow and Kyiv more than four years after Russia launched an all-out invasion of its neighbor. US-led diplo-

matic efforts to stop the war have come to nothing.

The Russian Defence Ministry declared a unilateral ceasefire in

Ukraine for Friday and Saturday, but said that it would strike back at the country if it tries to disrupt the festivities on Victory Day, which Russia marks annually on May 9.

Zelenskyy replied that Ukraine would observe a truce beginning at the end of Tuesday and would respond in kind to Russia's actions from that moment on. He didn't put an end date on the truce.

Russian forces fired 11 Iskander-M ballistic missiles and 164 strike drones at Ukraine overnight from Monday to Tuesday, including a jet-powered Shahed drone variant, the Ukrainian Air Force said.

Air defense units stopped 149 drones and one missile, but others got through, it said. Two ballistic missiles failed to reach their targets, the air force said without elaborating.

Russia has repeatedly hampered Ukraine's energy infrastructure during the war, which began on Feb 24, 2022.

Prominent cleric shot dead by ISIS men in Pak

PESHAWAR: A prominent cleric was on Tuesday shot dead by gunmen belonging to the Islamic State in a targeted attack in Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, police said. The motorcycle-borne gunmen ambushed the vehicle of Sheikh-ul-Hadith Maulana Muhammad Idrees in the Utmanzai area of Charsadda district, injuring two security guards accompanying him, they said.

Idrees, one of the senior and respected religious scholars in Pakistan, sustained critical injuries and died while being shifted to the district headquarters hospital. Two injured constables are currently receiving treatment. The Islamic State in Khorasan Province (ISKP) claimed responsibility for the attack that killed Idrees.

The assailants opened fire on the cleric while he was on his way to deliver a lecture at Darul Uloom Utmanzai, police said.

Cruise ship waiting for help after 3 died in suspected outbreak of rare hantavirus

The WHO says on Monday that passengers were asked to stay in their cabins

PRAIA: The nearly 150 people aboard a cruise ship off the coast of Cape Verde have been mostly confined to their cabins, according to footage obtained by The Associated Press, after three passengers died and at least four others were left ill in a suspected hantavirus outbreak.

The MV Hondius, a Dutch ship on a weekslong polar cruise from Argentina to Antarctica and several isolated islands in the South Atlantic, has been waiting for help after authorities on the island of



public health concerns. Footage showed the ship's decks mostly deserted and

only a few people with medical masks moving about. Common halls were empty as passengers were isolated in their cabins. At least five people with full protective gear, white overalls, boots, and face masks, were seen disembarking from the ship into a small vessel.

The World Health Organization said Monday passengers were asked to stay in their cabins and "limit their risk while disinfection and other measures are being taken."



GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PHE GROUND WATER DIVISION
SRINAGAR.
Baghi-Ali- MardanNowshera Srinagar.
Telephone No:- 0194-2411285
suresh05.gupta@jk.gov.in



PUBLIC NOTICE No:-01/2026-27 Dated: 5th May 2025
ATTENTION OF ALL GOVERNMENT/SEMI GOVERNMENT/PRIVATE FIRMS/USERS EXTRACTING GROUND WATER INCLUDING INDUSTRIAL/ INFRASTRUCTURE/ MINING PROJECTS

Whereas the Government of Jammu and Kashmir UT constituted the State Water Resources Regulatory Authority, (hereinafter referred to as the Authority) vide Jammu and Kashmir Water Resources (Regulation and Management) ACT, 2010, followed by Notification Number SRO 30 dated 24 January, 2011 for the purposes of regulation and control of ground water development and management in the whole of UT of Jammu and Kashmir and to issue necessary regulatory directions. And whereas the Authority has issued "Guidelines to control and regulate ground water extraction in UT J&K" vide above Notification, wherein chapter (v) provides that

Rule 58.
(1) Any person who desires to sink a well (other than a well fitted with a hand operated manual pump or other manual devices or a sub-surface well up to 20 meter depth), or use ground water, in any area notified by the Government under section 111 of the Act shall apply to Chief Engineer concerned in form- XI for grant of a permit for digging of such well or use of such water. Such application shall be accompanied by a fee of rupees twenty thousand and shall indicate the following information:-
(a) The description of source of ground water, such as type of well and its location;
(b) The purpose of using the water (whether domestic, commercial, industrial or trading purposes);
(c) The lifting device to be employed by the applicant for extraction of water;
(d) The quantity of water to be extracted or used;
(e) The time and duration of such extraction or use per day;
(f) The existence of other such users in the area; and
(g) Other details about the unit or scheme to be installed or operated by the applicant

Rule 60.
(1). Every existing user of ground water in a notified area shall, within 120 days from the date of notification under section 111 of the Act, apply to the Chief Engineer concerned for grant of a Certificate of Registration in the manner as provided under sub-rule (1) of rule 58:

Rule 61.
(1) After the commencement of these rules, every person desiring sinking a well (other than a well fitted with a hand operated manual pump or other manual devices or a sub-surface well up to 20 meter depth) in any area which is not notified under section 111 of the Act shall mandatorily inform the Executive Engineer concerned about the same with details of the well and its location.

Rule 63.
(1) Every drilling agency, whether owned by the Government, or any local body or a private individual, as soon as may be after the commencement of these rules but not later than 120 days, apply in form- XII to the Chief Engineer concerned for grant of registration. The application shall be accompanied by-
(a) A fee of rupees ten thousand;
(b) The name of the user agency;
(c) The purpose of having the drilling machinery;
(d) The description of machinery, its make, capacity and other technical details;
(e) Other information relevant to the drilling agency or sought by the Chief Engineer.
(2) After making such enquiries as the Chief Engineer may think proper, he may register the drilling agency and allot a registration number to such agency.

(3) The Executive Engineer concerned or an Assistant Executive Engineer authorized by the Executive Engineer in this behalf shall seize any drilling machine or other equipment of any drilling agency if it is not registered under sub-rule (1).
Therefore, it is impressed upon all concerned,
1. Not to drill any tube well / bore well / hand pump or take any such activity in areas of their jurisdiction in violation of the above rules without seeking proper permission from the Ground water Division Srinagar.
2. Those who have already taken such activity in past, are directed to register their Tube wells/ bore wells/works with Ground Water Division after filling details in the duly circulated proforma and depositing requisite fee.
3. All concerned of Government departments / Semi Government departments, / Institutes / Organizations etc are requested to desist from taking up the ground water tapping works viz drilling, extraction, distribution etc of their area. Instead, these shall be get executed through Ground Water Division which has been created by Government as a specialized division for executing such type of works

No.-JS-PHE/GWDS/26-27/Camp/998-1002
Dated:-05-05-2025

Sd/- Er. Hakeem Mushtaq Ahmad
Executive Engineer
Jal Shakti (PHE) Deptt.
Ground Water Division Srinagar.

No-DiPK-1042/26

10 | mp Sport

PNB’s net profit jumps 12.54% to ₹5,225.12 cr in March qtr of FY26

On standalone basis, net profit grew 14.4% year-on-year to Rs 5,225.11 cr

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: State-owned Punjab National Bank on Tuesday reported a 12.54 per cent year-on-year rise in its consolidated net profit at Rs 5,225.12 crore in the fourth quarter of the financial year 2025-26, citing a recovery in written-off accounts and a high fee base.

The bank had posted a net profit of Rs 4,642.87 crore in the corresponding quarter of FY25.

On a standalone basis, the net profit grew 14.4 per cent year-on-year to Rs 5,225.11 crore.

“There are two things which has driven to this quarter’s profit, one is that the recovery in the technical write-off that has added in the operating profit, and secondly, fee-based income. Both these have given boost to profit in this quarter,” said Ashok Chandra, managing director and chief executive officer of PNB, said.

Core net interest income of the bank fell by 3.5 per cent year-on-year to Rs 10,380 crore, from Rs 10,757 crore.

The bank expects that the net interest income will grow by 7 per cent in FY27.

Domestic net interest margins declined to 2.61 per cent in Q4FY26, from 2.65 per cent in the quarter ago period and 2.96



Core net interest income of the bank fell by 3.5 per cent year-on-year to Rs 10,380 crore, from Rs 10,757 crore

per cent in the year ago period.

Interest income grew to Rs 32,157 crore from Rs 31,989 crore recorded in the fourth quarter of the previous financial year.

Global advances increased by 12.7 per cent year-on-year to Rs 12.59 lakh crore as on March 31, 2026, from Rs 11.17 lakh crore a year ago.

RAM (retail, agriculture, and MSME) advances grew by 12.1 per cent year-on-year to Rs 6.76 lakh crore in Q4FY26, from Rs 6.03 lakh crore in the same quarter last year.

In the reporting quarter, total retail credit increased by

8.3 per cent year-on-year to Rs 2.81 lakh crore.

Core retail advances increased by 18.2 per cent year-on-year. Within the core retail credit segment, housing loan grew by 11.6 per cent year-on-year to Rs 1.29 lakh crore, and vehicle loans posted a growth of 35.1 per cent to reach Rs 35,199 crore.

Agriculture advances grew by 10.7 per cent to Rs 1,99,919 crore, and MSME advances increased by 19.9 per cent to Rs 1.95 lakh crore, the bank said in a release.

Chandra said that the bank expects the RAM segment

Highlights

» The bank expects that the net interest income will grow by 7 per cent in FY27

» Domestic net interest margins declined to 2.61% in Q4FY26, from 2.65% in the quarter ago period and 2.96% in the year ago period

» Interest income grew to Rs 32,157 crore from Rs 31,989 crore recorded in the fourth quarter of previous financial year

very good pipeline for the corporate credit.”

On the asset quality front, the bank’s gross Non-Performing Assets (NPAs) improved to 2.95 per cent of gross advances as compared to 3.95 per cent by the end of March 2025. Similarly, net NPAs came down to 0.29 per cent from 0.4 per cent.

Chandra added that the bank do have the exposure of Rs 3,800 crore to the West Asia, but do not find any stress on the books. The bank has done two rounds of webinar with all these exporters and importers who are doing business in the entire Middle East.

“As of now, there is no challenge in any of my book now. Even there is no stress also. So, people are able to manage as of now,” he added.

CRAR of the bank increased to 17.74 per cent as on March 31, 2026, from 17.01 per cent a year ago, showing an improvement of 0.73 per cent.

The board also recommended a dividend of Rs 3 per equity share for FY 2025-26, subject to approval of shareholders at the ensuing Annual General Meeting of the bank.

Shares of Punjab National Bank closed 0.83 per cent down at Rs 107.90 apiece on the BSE, while the broader Sensex ended 0.3 per cent down at 77,017.79.

Cabinet clears two new semicon units at investment of ₹3,936 cr

OUR CORRESPONDENT

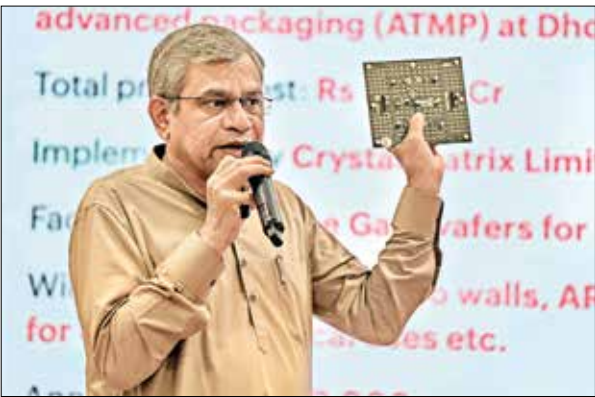
NEW DELHI: The Cabinet on Tuesday approved two more semiconductor manufacturing units with cumulative investment of more than Rs 3,936 crore, Union Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said.

The semiconductor projects have been approved under India Semiconductor Mission (ISM), which includes the country’s first commercial mini/micro-LED display facility based on GaN (Gallium Nitride) Technology and a semiconductor packaging facility, the minister said.

“These were the last two projects under ISM 1.0. The first project is for display. Crystal Matrix will set up a fabrication unit in two years and ATMP (assembly, testing, Marking, and Packaging) in about one and half years. Both work will go on parallelly. Suchi Semicon will make chips for TV, air conditioners,” Vaishnaw said.

The semiconductor manufacturing facilities will be set up in Gujarat with a cumulative investment of about Rs 3,936 crore. The projects are expected to generate cumulative employment for 2,230 skilled professionals, out of which 1,600 will be employed by Crystal Matrix.

South Korea-based Crystal Matrix Ltd (CML) will establish an integrated facility for compound semiconductor fabrication and ATMP in Dholera, Gujarat, for manufacturing mini/micro-LED display



Union Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw during a cabinet briefing, in New Delhi on Tuesday

PTI

modules.

Vaishnaw said the annual proposed production capacity for mini/micro-LED display panels is 72,000 square meters, and for mini-micro-LED GaN epitaxy wafers is 24,000 sets of RGB wafers.

“It is a new technology that will benefit the country for several years,” Vaishnaw said.

He said External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar played a key role in getting the interest from the South Korean firm.

The proposed products will have applications in large displays for TVs and signages, commercial displays, medium-sized displays for tablets, smartphones, and in-car displays, and Micro-displays for Extended Reality (XR) glasses and smart watches.

Suchi Semicon Private Limited (SSPL) will set up an Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility in Surat, Gujarat,

for manufacturing discrete semiconductors.

With these two approvals, the semiconductor ecosystem in the country would get a significant boost as the number of approved projects under India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) reaches 12, with cumulative investments of about Rs 1.64 lakh crore.

Vaishnaw said the government is building an entire ecosystem of semiconductors.

“We have picked up important projects for the ecosystem. The drivers that are used in making displays will be manufactured by Foxconn HCL joint venture in Noida. The entire capacity of the Micron plant inaugurated by the Prime Minister on February 28 and Keynes Semicon inaugurated on March 31 has been completely booked. Now there are no questions raised on India’s capability to produce semiconductors,” he said.

J&K Bank posts highest ever annual profit of ₹2,363.47 cr

SRINAGAR: J&K Bank has reported its highest-ever annual profit of Rs 2,363.47 crore for FY26, marking its fourth straight year of record earnings. The profit rose over 13 per cent year-on-year from Rs 2,082.46 crore in FY25, despite a one-time impairment provision of Rs 179 crore on its investment in J&K Grameen Bank.

The bank posted a net profit of nearly Rs 800 crore compared with Rs 584.54 crore in the year-ago period.

Net interest margin for the year stood at 3.60 per cent, while return on assets rose to 1.37 per cent annually & 1.78 per cent for Q4. The cost-to-income ratio improved to 56.18 per cent, & return on equity was 16.85 per cent. However, net interest income growth remained modest at Rs 5,875.77 crore due to a cumulative 125 basis points repo rate cut and intense deposit competition.

Total business grew 13.61 per cent to Rs 2,90,341 crore as of March 31, 2026. Deposits rose 11.30 per cent to Rs 1,65,354 crore, while advances increased 18 per cent to Rs 1,22,641 crore. CASA deposits stood at Rs 75,478 crore, with the ratio improving to 45.65 per cent.

Asset quality strengthened, with gross NPA declining to 2.5 per cent & net NPA at 0.64 per cent. Pro-vision coverage ratio remained above 90 per cent. Capital adequacy stood at 16.55 per cent.

MPOST

India fuel retailers face credit strain as high oil prices persist: Fitch

NEW DELHI: India’s oil marketing companies (OMCs) could face rising credit pressure if crude oil prices remain elevated, especially if domestic fuel prices are not adjusted in line with input costs, Fitch Ratings said on Tuesday.

The agency warned that sustained high crude prices—not short-term spikes—pose the biggest risk. Delayed pass-through of higher costs to retail fuel prices could quickly erode EBITDA, while large in-ventory holdings and refining volumes would increase working-capital requirements and strain free cash flow.

Fitch noted that the impact would vary across companies depending on business mix and capital expenditure intensity. Indian Oil Corporation’s (IOC) diversified operations are expected to provide rela-



tively greater resilience.

In contrast, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) may face tighter financial headroom due to ongoing expansion and energy transition investments.

Hindustan Petroleum Corporation’s credit profile could improve as major joint venture projects are completed, although a prolonged period of high oil prices may delay this recovery.

The report also highlighted

that persistently high crude prices could widen the credit gap among downstream companies across the Asia-Pacific region by exposing differences in business models and pressuring cash flows.

Under an adverse scenario where Brent crude averages around \$100 per barrel in 2026, pure refiners with margins linked to benchmarks are likely to outperform integrated fuel retailers that are more exposed to price controls.

Despite these pressures, issuer ratings in the region remain closely tied to sovereign or state owner-ship, which may limit the impact of weaker standalone credit profiles. Government policies, including fuel price controls and support measures, will continue to play a crucial role in shaping credit outcomes.

AGENCIES

Vedanta posts record FY26 earnings as demerger ushers in next growth phase, says Anil Agarwal

NEW DELHI: Billionaire Anil Agarwal said Vedanta Ltd delivered a record financial performance in FY26 and is entering a new phase of restructuring aimed at unlocking value through a planned demerger.

In a letter to shareholders, Agarwal said Vedanta posted its highest-ever profit after tax of Rs 25,096 crore on revenue of Rs 1,74,075 crore, driven by operational gains across businesses.

Total shareholder return was about 50 per cent, outperforming sector benchmarks, while the company paid a dividend of Rs 34 per share.

Vedanta also strengthened its balance sheet, with net debt-to-EBITDA improving to 0.95x, positioning it for greater financial flexibility, the Vedanta chairman said.

The company’s demerger, effective May 1, will split



Vedanta chairman Anil Agarwal

Vedanta into multiple sector-focused entities, each with independent growth strategies and capital allocation.

Agarwal said the move is designed to create “globally competitive” businesses with clearer strategic focus and scalability.

“Your company, Vedanta, is embarking on a very exciting new chapter, where strong performance meets exceptional transformation,” he said. “The stage is set for the next phase

of growth and value creation.”

The demerger marks a structural shift aimed at creating independent, sector-focused businesses. “This transformation marks a pivotal step in unlocking value by creating focused, world-class companies... each with sharper strategic clarity and distinct growth pathways,” he said.

Post-demerger, Vedanta Aluminium aims to double capacity to 6 million tonnes per year, targeting cost leadership and growth tied to global demand in infrastructure and manufacturing.

Vedanta oil & gas plans to scale production to 300,000-500,000 barrels per day with a \$5-billion investment programme.

Vedanta Power is targeting rapid expansion from 4.2 GW currently to a 12 GW pipeline,

while also exploring hydro-power and nuclear energy. Vedanta Iron & Steel plans to increase capacity from 4 million tonnes to 10 million tonnes, with further expansion potential supported by captive raw material resources.

The parent entity will retain stakes in key assets including Hindustan Zinc Limited, along with international zinc operations, copper, nickel and ferro alloys businesses, Agarwal said.

Vedanta invested about Rs 15,000 crore in growth capital expenditure during the year across aluminium, zinc, oil and gas, and emerging businesses.

Looking ahead, Agarwal said the group will focus on scale, cost efficiency and disciplined capital allocation, while increasing the use of technology and artificial intelligence to drive productivity.

PTI

Cabinet clears ₹5,659 cr 5-year cotton productivity mission

NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved a five-year Mission for Cotton Productivity with an outlay of Rs 5,659.22 crore, aimed at boosting yields, improving quality and addressing structural challenges in India’s cotton sector.

Chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Cabinet cleared the mission for 2026-27 to 2030-31 to tackle bottlenecks, declining growth and quality concerns.

The initiative aligns with the government’s ‘5F vision’—Farm to Fibre to Factory to Fashion to Foreign.

India’s cotton production is estimated at 291 lakh bales (170 kg each) in the 2025-26 crop year. The mission targets output of 498 lakh bales by 2031



by increasing lint productivity from 440 kg per hectare to 755 kg per hectare.

The programme will focus on developing high-yielding, climate-resilient and pest-resistant seed varieties, while scaling up advanced farming practices through state governments, Krishi Vigyan Kendras and State Agricultural Universities.

Technologies such as High

The initiative aligns with the government’s ‘5F vision’—Farm to Fibre to Factory to Fashion to Foreign

Density Planting System, closer spacing and integrated cotton management will be promoted, along with cultivation of Extra Long Staple cotton.

About 32 lakh farmers are expected to benefit from the mission, which was announced in the FY26 Budget.

It will be implemented jointly by the Ministries of Agriculture and Textiles, with support from 10 Indian Coun-

cil of Agricultural Research institutes, one Council for Scientific and Industrial Research institute and 10 centres under the All India Coordinated Research Project on cotton.

In the initial phase, 140 districts across 14 states will be covered, along with 2,000 ginning and pro-processing units to enhance fibre quality and reduce contamination.

The government said the mission would be a milestone in making India self-reliant in the cotton sector.

It includes plans to modernise ginning and processing units, strengthen cotton testing infrastructure with standardised and accredited facilities, and ensure reliable quality assessment aligned with

global benchmarks.

Branding and traceability initiatives under Kasturi Cotton Bharat will be expanded to position Indian cotton as a premium, sustainable product globally.

The mission also aims to digitally integrate mandis to improve price discovery and market access for farmers.

Additionally, it will promote cotton waste recycling and circular economy practices to improve resource efficiency and reduce environmental impact.

The initiative also seeks to diversify India’s fibre base by encouraging natural fibres such as flax, ramie, sisal, bamboo and banana, while advancing sustainable textile innovations.

AGENCIES

Automobile retail sales jump 12.94% to 26,11,317 units in April: FADA

Passenger vehicles retail sales were at a record 4,07,355 units last month as compared to 3,63,028 units in April 2025

NEW DELHI: Total automobile retail sales in India grew by 12.94 per cent with a record 26,11,317 units in April as compared to 23,12,221 units in the same month last year, making a bright start to the new fiscal, Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations said on Tuesday.

Sustained tailwinds from GST 2.0 affordability gains, RBI’s supportive rate stance, healthy rural cash flows post a strong rabi cycle and an extended marriage season helped the industry post a robust performance, Federation of Automobile Dealers

Associations (FADA) said in a statement.

Passenger vehicles (PV) retail sales were at a record 4,07,355 units last month as compared to 3,63,028 units in April 2025, a growth of 12.21 per cent, it added.

Two-wheelers also clocked best-ever monthly numbers at 19,16,258 units in April this year as compared to 16,95,638 units in the same month a year ago, at a growth of 13.01 per cent, it added.

FADA further said three-wheeler sales stood at 1,06,908 units last month as compared to 99,741 units in April 2025,

CLOSER LOOK

» Two-wheelers clocked 19,16,258 units in April this year as compared to 16,95,638 units in April 2025

» FADA further said three-wheeler sales stood at 1,06,908 units last month against 99,741 units in April 2025

» Commercial witnessed a growth of 15.02% at 99,339 units in April 2026 against 86,364 units in April 2025

up 7.19 per cent.

Commercial vehicles also witnessed a growth of 15.02 per cent at a record 99,339 units last month as compared to 86,364 units in April 2025, it added.

“The Indian auto retail industry has opened FY 2026-

27 on an exceptionally strong note, retailing 26,11,317 units in April 2026, a 12.94 per cent YoY expansion that delivers the highest-ever April in our records,” FADA Vice President Sai Giridhar said.

Five of the six vehicle categories, along with the total industry, registered all-time April records, he said, adding, “This clearly underlines that the structural demand momentum which defined the second half of FY26 has carried into the new financial year.”

Giridhar said in the PV segment, the defining feature was the continued “outperformance of Bharat over the metros” as rural sales grew 20.40 per cent, nearly three times the Urban pace of 7.11 per cent.

“This confirms the structural broadening of personal mobility into Tier-3 and rural India, supported by a small-car

revival, sustained SUV demand and a richer alternative-powertrain product mix where CNG share held firm at 22.62 per cent and EV share improved further to 5.77 per cent,” he said.

PV inventory levels have moved up modestly to a range of 28-30 days, marginally above March 2026 level of 28 days but well within the healthy band that we view as constructive, he said, while urging OEMs “to maintain disciplined dispatches in the coming weeks so that channel inventory stays anchored close to FADA’s recommended 21-day benchmark”.

PTI



Total income rose to ₹5,360 crore in Q4FY26 against ₹4,397 cr in Q4FY25

NEW DELHI: National Stock Exchange (NSE) on Tuesday reported an 8 per cent rise in consolidated profit after tax to Rs 2,871 crore for the March quarter, driven by higher transaction volumes across segments.

The exchange had posted a PAT of Rs 2,650 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous fiscal (Q4 FY25).

Its total income during the quarter increased 22 per cent to Rs 5,360 crore compared to Rs 4,397 crore in the year-ago period, the exchange said in a statement.

Sequentially, net profit rose 19 per cent from Rs 2,409 crore in Q3 FY26, while income climbed 22 per cent quarter-on-quarter, reflecting strong growth in trading activity, particularly in the equity derivatives segment.

On a consolidated basis, total expenditure in Q4 FY26 rose 20 per cent quarter-on-quarter to Rs 1,486 crore, largely due to a year-end CSR provision of Rs 223 crore compared to Rs 5 crore in the preceding quarter.

During the quarter, the exchange also recognised a provision of Rs 84 crore towards settlement applications related to the colocation and dark fibre matters. On March 13, NSE submitted revised settlement terms to markets regulator Sebi

for a cumulative amount of Rs 1,491.21 crore in these cases, which are currently pending final approval.

For the full financial year FY26, NSE reported a 15 per cent decline in PAT to Rs 10,302 crore against Rs 12,188 crore in FY25.

Also, the total income for the year stood at Rs 18,713 crore, marginally lower than Rs 19,177 crore in the previous fiscal.

The exchange said revenue from transaction charges surged 39 per cent year-on-year in the March quarter, supported by a sharp increase in volumes across equity cash and derivatives segments.

NSE’s contribution to the exchequer during FY26 stood at Rs 59,186 crore.

The board has recommended a final dividend of Rs 35 per share for FY26, subject to shareholder approval. This includes a special one-time dividend of Rs 10 per equity share.

MPOST

Govt issues updated SOP to clear FDI applications within 12 weeks

Govt's 2017 SOP had prescribed maximum 10 weeks to clear proposal

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government will now clear all FDI proposals within 12 weeks as per the updated standard operating procedure (SOP) for processing foreign direct investment applications.

According to the SOP, up to 12 weeks' time has been fixed for a decision on the proposals, excluding the time taken by applicants in removing deficiencies in the proposals or in supplying additional information as may be required by the competent authority.

The government's 2017 SOP had prescribed a maximum of 10 weeks for clearing the proposal.

As per the current SOP, the additional two weeks will also be given to the department for promotion of industry and internal trade (DPIIT) for consideration of those proposals which are proposed for rejection or where additional conditions are proposed to be imposed by the competent authority.

"This SOP aims to make the FDI application filing process completely paperless. Therefore, the applicant will not be required to file physical copies of any documents required to process FDI proposals," the



Additional two weeks will be given to DPIIT to consider those proposals which are proposed for rejection or where additional conditions are proposed to be imposed by the competent authority

DPIIT said.

As per the fresh SOP, all applications will be forwarded to the Ministry of External Affairs for their comments/clearance on investments from countries sharing a land border with India and, in other cases, where necessary, within the stipulated time period.

It added that all the ministries and departments consulted on any proposal,

Highlights

» 'The applicant will not be required to file physical copies of any documents required to process FDI proposals'

» All applications will be forwarded to the Ministry of External Affairs for their comments/clearance on investments from countries sharing a land border with India

» Further, the government has decided to provide expedited clearance (within 60 days) for investors of countries sharing a land border with India

including the RBI, the home ministry and the external affairs ministry, will have to provide their comments within the timeline, and in case comments are not received within the prescribed time, it will be presumed that they have no comments to offer.

The SOP also includes separate guidelines on investments from countries sharing a land border with India

(China, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Afghanistan).

Last month, the government eased FDI norms for foreign companies having a Chinese/Hong Kong shareholding of up to 10 per cent (or non-controlling stake), enabling them to invest in India under the automatic route, subject to applicable sectoral conditions and FDI caps.

Further, the government has decided to provide expedited clearance (within 60 days) for investors of these seven countries in specific sectors/activities.

These sectors include capital goods manufacturing (heavy electrical industries like insulation items for power plants, castings and forgings, alloy steel seamless pipes and tubes, and machine tools); and electronic capital goods and electronic component manufacturing (like printed circuit boards, display module, camera module, electronic capacitors, resistors, speakers and microphones for ICT products).

These sectors also include polysilicon wafers, advanced battery components, rare earth permanent magnets, and rare earth processing.

Further, it said that in case of proposals involving total

foreign equity inflow of more than Rs 5,000 crore, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) will take a decision.

The applications requiring government approval need to be filed online through the Foreign Investment Facilitation/ NSWS (National Single Window System) portal.

Administrative ministries and departments will examine the proposals on the portal.

After a proposal is filed online, the DPIIT will identify the concerned ministry and assign it within the prescribed timeline for processing and disposal of the application.

The proposal will have to be circulated online to the RBI for comments, and applications that require security clearance will also be referred to the Ministry of Home Affairs.

It added that if an applicant proposes to surrender the approval letter granted to the investee entity/investor, then the concerned ministry may accept it after the applicant submits such a declaration clearly explaining the reasons for that.

As per the new SOP, the time limit for submission of comments by the MHA, MEA, and any other consulted ministry/RBI/Regulator will be eight weeks.

Govt lists 40 sub-sectors for faster FDI nod from bordering nations

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Rare earth magnets and printed circuit boards are among 40 sub-sectors identified by the government for expedited clearance within 60 days of FDI proposals from China and other countries sharing land borders with India.

The government has also laid out procedural guidelines for foreign direct investment (FDI) proposals from these countries - China, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Afghanistan - in the specified sectors or activities, according to the updated standard operating procedure for processing of FDI proposals.

The move follows a decision by the government in March to process and decide foreign direct investment proposals from these countries in specified manufacturing sectors or activities within 60 days.

However, it has stated that in these cases, the majority shareholding and control of the investee entity will be with resident Indian citizens/or resident Indian entity owned and controlled by Indians at all times.

The 40 sub-sectors are under six broad sectors - capital goods manufacturing, electronic capital goods and electronic component manufacturing, polysilicon (and ingot-) wafers, advanced battery components, rare earth permanent magnets, and rare earth processing.



Printed circuit boards

The move follows a decision by the government in March to process and decide FDI proposals from these countries in specified manufacturing sectors or activities within 60 day

The sub-sectors included manufacturing of insulation items; castings and forgings required in thermal/hydro/nuclear power plants; machine tools; display components (plasma, polymer, LCD, LED); camera module; electronic capacitors; speakers and microphones for ICT products; Li-ion batteries; wearables; and rare earth metal, alloy and magnet making facility.

Further, in the SOP, the government has also rolled out reporting guidelines for investments into India from a company having any direct or indirect ownership by a cit-

izen or an entity of a country sharing a land border with India.

"The reporting under these guidelines will be governed under the Foreign Exchange Management (Mode of Payment and Reporting of Non-debt Instruments) Regulations, 2019, and the information will be accessible by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)," the DPIIT's SOP said.

The onus of reporting will be on the Indian investee firm, which has to submit the information or documents to the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT).

"The reporting is to be made prior to the inward remittance of foreign capital. In cases which do not involve foreign capital inward remittances, the reporting is to be made prior to execution of the relevant transactions, including issuance/transfer of capital instruments, as the case may be," it added.

According to the reporting norms, the investor will have to provide details such as shareholding pattern, beneficial owners, organisation and group structure, promoters, board composition and key managerial personnel, along with corresponding citizenship status, and details of control rights.

The Indian investee entity needs to disclose incorporation details, shareholding pattern, and existing or proposed shareholding by a land-bordering country entity.

DII's holding hits record 20.9% in Nifty 500 in March quarter, FII ownership falls to 17%

NEW DELHI: Domestic institutional investors (DIIs) have strengthened their grip on Indian equities, with holdings in Nifty 500 companies rising to a record 20.9 per cent in the March quarter even as foreign institutional investor (FII) ownership declined to 17.1 per cent, according to a report released by Motilal Oswal Financial Services on Tuesday.

The report noted that Indian equity markets remained volatile in FY26, driven by global uncertainties, particularly geopolitical tensions arising from the Iran-Israel/US conflict, even as domestic flows provided strong support.

DIIs continued to anchor the markets, investing \$27.2 billion in the January-March 2026 period, supported by steady systematic investment plan (SIP)

inflows. In contrast, FII flows remained volatile, with net outflows of \$15.8 billion during the quarter, including massive selling of \$14.2 billion in March following escalation in geopolitical tensions.

"Once the war dust settles, there is a high likelihood of a better FII flow environment, and even an abatement in outflows will be taken positively by the market, while a full-blown positive flow can lead to sharper rallies," the report noted.

The FII-DII ownership ratio in the Nifty 500 contracted to 0.8 times in March 2026, reflecting a structural shift in institutional ownership. While FII ownership in free float terms declined to 33.8 per cent, DII ownership rose to 41.2 per cent, it added.

On a year-on-year basis, DII

holdings in the Nifty 500 rose 170 basis points to an all-time high of 20.9 per cent in March 2026, whereas FII holdings fell to 17.1 per cent from 18.9 per cent a year ago.

Promoter holdings remained largely stable at 49.4 per cent, while retail participation edged up to 12.7 per cent during the same period.

Sectorally, DIIs increased their exposure in 21 out of 24 sectors, with the highest incremental allocations seen in private banks, technology, telecom, real estate, healthcare and NBFC-lending segments. However, sectors such as EMS, NBFC (non-lending) and metals saw a decline in DII holdings.

FII allocation trends showed reduced exposure to the BFSI segment, which fell to 32.1 per

cent, while allocations increased in metals, healthcare, utilities and oil and gas.

Notably, FII exposure to the technology sector declined to a record low of 7.3 per cent in March 2026.

The report said large, mid and small-cap stocks accounted for 67 per cent, 22 per cent and 11 per cent, respectively, of the total Nifty 500 market capitalisation.

DIIs increased their exposure across both private and PSU segments to 21.5 per cent and 17.5 per cent, respectively.

The report highlighted that domestic investors continue to play a pivotal role in absorbing market volatility, and any moderation in FII outflows or a return to positive inflows could further support equity markets.

PFI

Stock markets decline under selling pressure as fresh tensions flared in Strait of Hormuz

The rupee appreciates by 5 paise to 95.18 against the US dollar

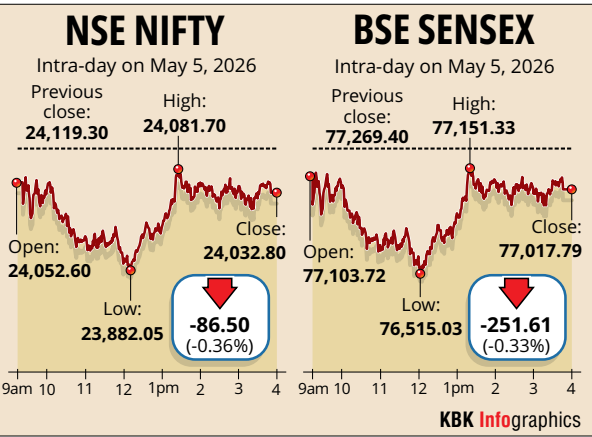
MUMBAI: Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty buckled under selling pressure on Tuesday as fresh tensions flared in the Strait of Hormuz region and the ceasefire between the US and Iran came under strain.

In a volatile session, the 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 251.61 points, or 0.33 per cent, to settle at 77,017.79.

The 50-share NSE Nifty edged lower by 86.50 points, or 0.36 per cent, to end at 24,032.80.

From the Sensex firms, ICICI Bank, Eternal, Tech Mahindra, Axis Bank, Bharti Airtel and Larsen & Toubro were among the major laggards.

On the other hand, Mahin-



dra & Mahindra, UltraTech Cement, Bajaj Finserv and Bajaj Finance were top gainers.

In the broader market,

the BSE MidCap Select index dipped 0.12 per cent, while the SmallCap Select index went up marginally by 0.14 per cent.

Sectorally, Realty dropped 1.38 per cent, Top 10 Banks (0.79 per cent), Services (0.63 per cent), Consumer Durables (0.62 per cent), Private Banks (0.60 per cent) and Bankex (0.58 per cent).

In contrast, Power, FMCG, Commodities, Healthcare, IT, Telecom, Utilities, Auto, Capital Goods, Focused IT and MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt were the gainers.

The rupee recovered from all-time intra-day low to settle at 95.18 against the US dollar, higher by 5 paise, on Tuesday on possible RBI intervention after investors retreated from riskier assets amid renewed clashes in the Gulf, which reignited supply chain fears.

PFI

M&M posts 48.5% jump in PAT to ₹5,259.91 cr in March qtr of FY26

MUMBAI: Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd on Tuesday reported a 48.5 per cent jump in consolidated profit after tax (PAT) to Rs 5,259.91 crore during the March quarter, primarily driven by its auto and farm sectors.

The company had posted a consolidated profit after tax (PAT) of Rs 3,541.85 crore in the corresponding period of the previous fiscal year, Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd (M&M) said in a regulatory filing.

Consolidated revenue from operations in the fourth quarter of the previous fiscal year stood at Rs 54,891.55 crore, as against Rs 42,585.67 crore in the year-ago period, it added.

Consolidated revenue from operations in the fourth quarter of the previous fiscal year stood at Rs 54,891.55 crore

Total expenses were higher at Rs 49,615.48 crore, as compared to Rs 39,113.61 crore a year earlier, the company said.

For FY26, consolidated PAT was Rs 18,621.71 crore compared to Rs 14,073.17 crore in FY25, up 32.32 per cent.

Consolidated revenue from

operations in FY26 stood at Rs 1,97,792.78 crore as against Rs 1,58,749.75 crore in FY25, the company said.

On the outlook, the company said the tractor industry is expected to grow in low-to-mid single digit during the current year, adding that the company is aspiring for mid- to high teen growth in the SUV segment for FY27.

It also said the manufacturing capacity ramp-up plans are on-track to meet the volume growth the company is aspiring for.

On the other hand, the LCV (<3.5T) segment is estimated to grow in the high single-digits in the ongoing fiscal year.

PFI

Alignment of policies at the Centre & State to accelerate Bengal's growth: Sanjay Budhia

KOLKATA: "The clear, considered and decisive mandate, resulting into alignment of the policies at the Centre and the State (like 1+1=11), will augment and fast track the momentum and progress of our Beloved State," Sanjay Budhia, MD - PATTON International Limited said on Tuesday.

Bengal has been our Karm-abhoomi. With 3600 Direct Employees & 8 Manufacturing Plants Exporting to most Quality and Time Conscious Countries like USA, Canada & Mexico etc. We have always been committed to Bengal & will continue to do so with accelerated speed, he added.

Meanwhile, industry bodies



Sanjay Budhia, MD – PATTON International Limited

& trade associations on Monday expressed optimism that the new government in West Bengal would accelerate industrialisation, improve infrastructure and introduce investor-friendly policies backed by stronger Centre-State coordination.

Bharat Chamber of Commerce president Naresh Pach-

sia said the state stood at the cusp of a "new dawn", driven by expectations of big-ticket investments and faster industrial growth. He underlined the importance of transparent governance, business-friendly policies, stable labour relations and swift steps to improve Bengal's image among investors.

Restoring investor confidence quickly would be key to reviving the state's legacy as a leading industrial hub, Pachisia said. He also called for diversified resource mobilisation, including tapping central schemes and global funding, along with stronger governance to plug revenue leakages.

The Bengal Chamber of

Commerce & Industry said it looked forward to improved ease of doing business, policy stability, employment generation and stronger investor confidence. It highlighted priorities such as world-class infrastructure, plug-and-play ecosystems, future-ready skilling and a robust industrial and IT policy framework.

West Bengal Hosiery Association president Sudesh Agarwal sought special support for the textile sector, better Centre-State coordination and faster implementation of schemes, noting the state's potential to become a competitive textile hub amid shifting global supply chains.

MPOST

India smartphone supplies to decline 10-12% in 2026, Vivo tops Q1 chart: CMR

Vivo led overall smartphone market with 21% share followed by Samsung (17%), Oppo (14%), Xiaomi (12%) & Realme (10%)

NEW DELHI: India smartphone shipments are expected to decline 10-12 per cent this year due to rise in memory cost driving up prices, market research firm CMR said in a report on Tuesday.

According to the CMR India Mobile Handset Market Review Report, the country's smartphone market recorded a decline of 2 per cent in shipment on a year-on-year (YoY) basis due to a sharp rise in DRAM and NAND flash prices, which pushed up device costs and forced brands to increase pricing -- leading price-sensitive consumers to defer upgrades.



CyberMedia Research (CMR), VP-Industry Research Group, Prabhuram said India's 2026 smartphone market decline reflects a mix of structural cost pressures and cautious demand.

"Elevated DRAM and

CLOSER LOOK

» Apple shipments in India increased 6 per cent YoY and 9 per cent market share during the reported quarter

» Shipment of only Vivo and Oppo grew in Q1 of 2026 by 1% and 12% respectively among top-five brands

» While Samsung, Xiaomi & Realme recorded decline in supplies by 8%, 7% & 12%, respectively, on YoY basis

NAND prices have raised device costs, squeezing affordability in mass segments, while the premium end remains relatively insulated. At the same time, channel inventory corrections and more value-conscious consumers are extending upgrade

cycles. Together, these factors are driving near-term volume pressure -- especially in the affordable and value-for-money tiers -- resulting in the projected 10-12 per cent decline in 2026," he said.

Apple shipments in India

increased 6 per cent YoY and 9 per cent market share during the reported quarter.

Surprisingly, Apple shipments were driven by demand for iPhone 16 during the reported quarter.

"Apple reached 9 per cent shipment share in Q1 2026. The iPhone 16 series contributed 53 per cent of volumes, while the newly launched iPhone 17 series captured 28 per cent share -- a healthy upgrade cycle that validates the premium segment's relative insulation from memory-driven pricing stress," the report said.

The CyberMedia Research

report estimates that shipment of only Vivo and Oppo grew in the first quarter (Q1) of 2026 by 1 per cent and 12 per cent respectively among top-five brands while Samsung, Xiaomi and Realme recorded decline in supplies by 8 per cent, 7 per cent, and 12 per cent, respectively, on YoY basis.

Chinese smartphone brand Vivo led the overall smartphone market with 21 per cent share followed by Samsung with 17 per cent share, Oppo 14 per cent, Xiaomi 12 per cent and Realme 10 per cent.

CMR report estimates Transsion and OnePlus were

the biggest losers with 30 per cent and 28 per cent decline in shipments on a YoY basis.

In the feature phone segment, Chinese brand itel Mobile led the market with 35 per cent share despite a steep decline in its shipments by 26 per cent. It was followed by Lava with 34 per cent share and HMD with 18 per cent share during the reported quarter.

Among chipset players, MediaTek led India's smartphone chipset market with 48 per cent share. Qualcomm led the premium segment (above Rs 25,000) with 36 per cent market share.

PFI

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No. 114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/5890/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

DP/5899/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

ICICI Bank

The following borrower(s) has/have facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. A Notice was issued to them under Enforcement of Security Interest Act, therefore being notified by way of this.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address
1.	Ranjeet Sahani/rakhi Kumari/ C/o, Chhalatar Sahani, 324, 2nd Floor, Krishna Villa, Ananda Pally West Regent Park Purba Puttary, New Friends Association Club West Bengal Kolkata - 700093/ LBCAL00005157604

These steps are being taken for (s) applicable is/are advised to make Notice. Also, further steps will be Financial Assets and Enforcement of Date: May 06, 2026 Place: New Delhi

PR 379012
Building(26-27)D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

By Order
Ms. Shagun
JMFC-06, North West, Room No. 109,
1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

NORTHERN RAILWAY				
INVITATION OF TENDERS THROUGH E-PROCUREMENT SYSTEM				
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for the supply of the following items:-				
S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
1.	06261139	M.S. FLAT SIZE 50X6MM X STANDARD LENGTH	500000 KGS	22.05.2026
2.	06251002	PIG IRON FOR FOUNDRY PURPLE	283738 KGS	25.05.2026
3.	09263050	GENTIAN BLUE ENAMEL FINISHING PAINT	154717 NOS.	28.05.2026
4.	77269020 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR METAL LINERS	1021000 NOS.	20.05.2026
5.	77269061 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR HVN LINERS (T-8992)	622530 NOS.	29.05.2026
6.	02260081	HIGH VOLTAGE FUSE RATING 125A WITH FUSE	4905 NOS.	01.06.2026
7.	12260029A	EARTHING CABLE COMPLETE	17350 NOS.	08.06.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE				
		Branch Office: ICICI BANK LTD, BP-4, Technopolis Building, 4th Floor, Sector V, Salt Lake City, Kolkata West Bengal- 700091. CIN No: L65190GJ1994PLC021012, www.icicibank.com		
The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA). A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.				
Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Description of Secured Asset to be enforced	Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Ranjeet Sahani/rakhi Kumari/ C/o. Choditar Sahani, 324, 2nd Floor, Krishna Villa, Ananda Pally West Regent Park Purba Putney, Friends Association Club West Bengal Kolkata- 700093/ LBCAL0000517604	"Krishna Villa", Flat on 2nd Floor, Northern Side, Municipal Premises No. 324, Ananda Pally, Block-B, Dag No. 483, Khation No. 34, J.L. No. 44, Touzi No. 351, Mouza Chakdakh, P.S. Regent Park, Assesee No. 31-114-01-0324-3, Ward No. 114, Kolkata Municipal Corporation, District - South 24 Paraganas, Kolkata - 700093, West Bengal, Owned By Ranjeet Sahani And Rakhi Kumari Admeasuring An Area of 850 Sqft. Super Built-up Area Together With The Proportionate Undevided And Impartible Share In The Land of The Said Premises Along With Common Rights In The Common Areas And Portion, Facilities Of The Said Building/said Premises Together With Other Rights, Benefits And Privileges Appurtenant Thereto For The Beneficial Use And Enjoyment Of The Said Flat.	28/03/2026 Rs. 21,91,433/-	01/02/2026

HQ District Police, Kupwara, UT of J&K.
Email: dpkupwara@jkipolice.gov.in
NO:- CRB/Lockout Notice/2026/ 25109-35 Dated: :2/05/2026

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by SHO P/S Kupwara vide letter No. 1003/5-A/P/PSK/2026 dated 30-04-2026, that accused Ishfaq Ahmad Mir S/O Aashiq Hussain Mir O/P Sulaiman A/P Magray Mohalla Gulgam is involved in case FIR No. 13/2026 U/S 8/21, 29 NDPS Act of P/S Kupwara and is absconding after commission of crime. Despite strenuous efforts, whereabouts of the said accused are not ascertained so far. The Photograph alongwith description roll of absconding accused person is as under:

Description Roll	Photograph
Name:- Ishfaq Ahmad Mir	
Parentage:- Aashiq Hussain Mir	
Address:- Sulaiman A/P Magray Mohalla Gulgam	
Age:- 32 years	
Height:- 5 Feet 10 Inch	
Face:- Oval	
Complexion:- Brown	
Build:- Normal	

It is therefore requested that a sharp lookout may please be maintained and if traced out or any clue leading to the whereabouts of said absconding accused, immediate information may kindly be shared on the below mentioned Email/phone no's.

Email: dpokupwara@jkpolice.gov.in
PCR Kupwara:- 7051404938
SHO P/S Kupwara:- 7051404914
PS Kupwara:- 7051404915

Sd/-
Syed Al-Tahir Glani) JKPS
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Kupwara

DIP No:DIP/J-1562/26

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Santosh S/o Rajender R/o H.No. 04, C-Block, Basantpur, Faridabad, Haryana**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 161/19 Dt. 03.05.2019 U/s 279/304A IPC.**, has been registered at **P.S. Kalindi Kunj, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Santosh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Santosh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Santosh of FIR No. 161/19 Dt. 03.05.2019 U/s 279/304A IPC.**, registered at **P.S. Kalindi Kunj, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.06.2026**.

Bv Order

DP/5870/SE/2026
(Court Notice)

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person, namely, **Bhagwati Prasad, S/o Jagdish Prasad R/o VE-5/A, Virendra Nagar, 2nd Floor, New Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **Ct. Cases/CC NI Act: 17515/16, U/s: 138 NI Act, P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Bhagwati Prasad**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Bhagwati Prasad**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Bhagwati Prasad, Ct. Cases/CC NI Act: 17515/16, U/s: 138 NI Act, P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.06.2026**.

By Order

DP/5874/WD/2026
(Court Matter)



Suryoday Finance Bank Limited
Regd. & Corp. office : 1101, Sharda Terraces, Plot 65, Sector - 11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai - 400614, CIn: 165923MH2008PLC216472.

Under Section 13 (2) of The Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002

Whereas the undersigned is the Authorised officer of the M/s. Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd. ("SFB") under Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) read with Rule 3 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued Demand Notices under Section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower(s) to discharge in full their liability to the SFB by the due date of the said demand, the necessary payment of entire outstanding including up to date interest, cost and charges within 60 days from the date of respective Notices issued and the publication of the Notice as given below and way of alternate service to you, as Security for due repayment of the loan, the following Security Asset(s) have been mortgaged to SFB by the said Borrower(s), Co-Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) respectively.

Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Guarantor	Date of Demand Notice	Date of NPA	Total Outstanding Amount in Rs.
24700005431, 1.MR. RAJESH KUMAR GADGIL S/O RISHI KESH GADGIL, 2. MRS. RITU GADGIL W/O RAJESH KUMAR GADGIL		05.04.2026	Rs 38,38,862.47/-

Absolute Sole Owner And In Possession Of Built-Up Second Floor Without Roof Rights. Out Of Property Plot Bearing No.-115 Near No.-15a, Area Measuring 100 Sq. Yds., Out Of Kharsa No. 101 And 433, Station Area Of Newa-Nagar, Near To The Police Station, Near To The Mohan Garden, In Block-1, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059, Fully Fitted With Separate Meters & Connection Of Electricity, Water, Common Sewer Connections In Working Orders, With Kitchen, Bath, Bed Room, Living Room, Two Approximate Rents, The Property Is Situated Underneath And With Common Rights To Use Ingress & Egress, Common Staircase & Passage, Common Entrance, With All Its Fittings And Fixtures Installed Thereto, Including Wooden, Sanitary And Electrical Etc. With All Its Rights, Interposits, Easements, Title, Claims, Demands, Liabilities, And All Other Rights, And The Property Is Not Registered As Document No.13014, In Book No.1, Vol. No.7639, On Dated 27/8 To 86, On 07/06/2022, In The Office Of The Sub-Registrar-III, Janki Pur, New Delhi-110058, Executed Extempore By Shri. Ashwini K. W. Sir Das Gupta, Notary Public, New Delhi-110058, East-1: 15, West-1: 14, North: Galt 10 Ft., South: Road 20 Ft., (Hereinafter Called The Property).	
2570000033370, 1. MR. NARESH SAINI SO DSH RANJAN SAINI, 2.MRS. MEGHA SAINI W/O NARESH SAINI	
Date of Demand Notice	15.04.2026
Date of NPA	05.04.2026
Total Outstanding Amount In Rs.	13,12,633.31/- as on 08.04.2026
Description of Secured Asset(s) Immoveable Property (ies): All Part and Parcel Of First Floor (Rear Left Side Property) Without Roof/Rights To Property To Property Plot Bearing No.115 Near No.15a, Area Measuring Area 50 Sq. Yds., Etc. 41.81 Sq. Mtrs., Out Of Kharsa No.123, Situated In The Revenue Estate Of Village Binqpur, Delhi State India, Area Abadi Known As Colony O-BLOCK, Near To The Sector 34/2, Near To The Sector 34/2, Near To The Sector 34/2, East - Property No.38, West - Part Of Building, North - Front Property, South - Galt 10 Ft. Wide.	
Date : 06.05.2026. Place : Delhi	Authorised Officer, Survey No.31, Surda Finance Park Limited

 NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY	
E-Tender Notice	
Sr. DEE/TRD/Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on-line only (e-Tendering) for the following work:	
Tender No. : AGCTR/DT202610	Approximate Cost : Rs. 1,93,11,528.12/-
Name of work : Non Power Block activities for OHE maintenance in IDH-BKI & MTJ-AH sections for Agra division for a period of 24 months.	
Earnest Money for Rs. 3,86,200/-	Period for completion : 24 months
1. For full details & submission of the bid please see the Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in 2. Tender can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15:00 Hrs. on date 25.05.2026 978/26 (C)	
 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @ CPNCRN	



New Okhla Industrial Development Authority

Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida-201301 (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **<http://etender.up.nic.in>**. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

1.	33/S.M.-Ja-III/E.T./2025-26 , Strengthening of W/s (P/Laying Separate Water line for Kendriya Vihar Society Sector-51), Noida. Cost Rs. 24.95 Lacs
2.	11/S.M.-Ja-O.A./E.T./2025-26 , M/o STP (Two years Maintenance of Irrigation line from UGR, STP-50 to J-Block, Sector-41 and Golf Course to Botanical Garden), Noida. Cost Rs. 29.95 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date: 12.05.2026 Upto 5.00 PM.
pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: - 13.05.2026 at 11.00 AM.

Sector-5, NOIDA

General Manager (JAL)
NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.-GSU-ST-PNKD-5-2026

Date: 30.04.2026

E-Tender Notice

Dy. CSTE Gati Shakti Unit (Signal & telecommunication), N. C. Railway PRYJ for and on behalf of the President of India invites open E-tender on prescribed form for the following work up to 12.00 hrs on the opening date of E- tender mentioned therein. **The details of the Tender are as under:-**

SN.:	Tender No.: 5	Approx. Cost of work (Rs.): ₹ 398992276.97
-------------	----------------------	---

Name of Work: Modification/alteration in existing EI (Medha make), associated indoor and outdoor work in connection with Phase work at Panki Dham station, in CNB-TDL section of Prayagraj Division.

Earnest Money (₹): ₹ 7980000.0	Cost of Tender Form : 0.00
Completion Period: 3 Months	Date of Closing of tender: 22.05.2026

2 Availability of tender form : Tender forms shall be available on www.irps.gov.in. **3. Time date & place of opening of tender :** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre determined date at 12.30 hours.

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

97526(DG)

[f North central railways](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)

[✉ @CPNCR](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. JHS/W/T/Tender General/98

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENG-GH-2026-98, Description of work: Jhansi East: Horticulture work of east colony like redevelopment of lawns, parks, adding new landscaping, plantation of etc. under ADEN HQ-II for five year.

Approx. Cost : ₹ 3,00,52,394.11 Earnest Money :- ₹ 6,01,100.00
--

Date of closing Tender : 27.05.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
--

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 60 Months
--

(1) Tender online can be submitted upto to **15:00 hrs on 27.05.2026** (2) For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.reps.gov.in

Date : 04.05.2026

www.northcentralrailways.in

 ©PRONCR

 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

985/26 (MC)

NORTHERN RAILWAY NOTICE INVITING TENDER	
Name of work and its location	78-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27 Electrical work in connection with (i) Improvement to damaged flooring, walls, rooms, halls, staircase of Accounts Building Annex-II at Baroda House New Delhi. ii) Improvement of General Admin Section of G branch, GM's Conference hall at main building at Ground Floor & first floor at Annex-I at Baroda House. iii) Improvement of halls, rooms of store department in Annex-II at Baroda House.
	Approx. cost of the works in Rs. 8997820.00/-
	Address of the office Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055
	Earnest Money Rs. 180000.00/-
	Last Date & time of submission of tender 26.05.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender 26.05.2026, 16.00 Hrs.	
Website & notice board www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Dwt. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi	
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE	
1490/2026	



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Notice No.:- DRM/C/AGRA/NFR/E-AUCTION

E-Auction Notice

Dated: 30.04.2026

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager- North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per category given as under:-

Category: Misc-Static-Services	Catalogue No.: BOC-AGRA-26-01
Asset Details: Contract of Battery Operated Cart at Idgah Jn. Railway Station.	E-Auction Start Date and Time Date:- 14.05.2026, Time:- 11:00
	E-Auction End Date and Time Date:- 14.05.2026, Time:- 11:30
Asset Details: Contract of Battery Operated Cart at Agra Cantt. Railway Station.	E-Auction Start Date and Time Date:- 14.05.2026, Time:- 11:10
	E-Auction End Date and Time Date:- 14.05.2026, Time:- 11:40

Note: Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **98926 (ADM)**



www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY	
Letter No.:-DRM/CI/AGRA/Parcel/E-AUCTION	Date: 30.04.2026
E-Auction Notice	
On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway- Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-	
	Asset Details
Category: Parcel	1. 01 (F1) SLR Unitin Train no. 12195- Friday
	2. 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train no. 19818- Sunday, Thursday & Friday
	3. 01 (F1) SLR Unitin Train no. 14854
Auction Catalogue No. : AGRA- LEASING- 48	4. 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train no. 19818- Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Saturday
	5. 01 (F1) SLR Unitin Train no. 12547
	6. 01 (F1) SLR Unitin Train no. 13168
	7. 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train no. 12195- Tuesday, Thursday & Saturday
	8. 01 (R1) SLR Unitin Train no. 20976
	9. 01 (F1) SLR Unitin Train no. 59814
	10. 01 (F1) SLR Unitin Train no. 12180
	11. 01 (F1) SLR Unitin Train no. 11905
	12. 01 round trip VP Unitin Train no. 15110-15019
E-Auction Start Date and Time:- Date 15.05.2026 Time:-13:00	
E-Auction End Date and Time: Date 15.05.2026 Time:-15:20	
Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Auction Number.	
969/26 (MG)	
www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in	



Meet the Indians who ruled MET GALA 2026

Indian celebrities carried forward a rich legacy of culture, art and craftsmanship

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Making his Met Gala debut, filmmaker and producer Karan Johar didn't mince words, crediting his dear friend Shah Rukh Khan for his journey. Wearing a six-foot hand-painted cape inspired by the art of iconic Raja Ravi Varma, complete with intricate zardozi embroidery, the 'Kuch Kuch Hota Hai' filmmaker said, "Shah Rukh is the reason I stand here today. He is a large part of my career repertoire."

The outfit, designed by his close friend Manish Malhotra, also paid tribute to Indian cinema. Malhotra himself was present at the Met Gala and like Johar, wore a black ensemble with an architectural cape, his look serving as a tribute to his hometown, Mumbai. Last year, Shah Rukh Khan made his Met Gala debut.

Held at New York's Metropolitan Museum of Art, this year's Met Gala theme, 'Costume Art', brought together global stars, including Indian celebrities whose outfits blended art, fashion and tradition. From Bollywood icons to business leaders, their red carpet appearances reflected

Indian heritage in a modern, artistic way.

Take the ensemble of businesswoman Ananya Birla. In dramatic black couture styled by Rhea Kapoor, she stole the show. The highlight, of course, was the metallic face mask created by Subodh Gupta, which upped the drama of the look.

Another businesswoman, Isha Ambani, opted for designer Gaurav Gupta's hand-woven gold-thread sari. It took 50 artisans and more than 1,200 hours to complete the ensemble.

In another homage to Indian tradition, Princess Gauravi Kumari revamped her grandmother Gayatri Devi's sari into a flowing gown. At the same time, Sawai Padmanabh Singh wore a velvet coat inspired by Rajasthani craftsmanship.

Businesswoman Natasha Poonawalla wore a sculptural floral outfit by Marc Quinn layered over a white gown by 'Dolce & Gabbana', creating a bold look. Manish Malhotra also took inspiration from the Indian art form Kalamkari to create a custom 'Tree of Life' ensemble for businesswoman Sudha Reddy.

Another highlight of the event was Indian fashion consultant Diya Mehta Jati's ensemble, which paid tribute to the

Diya Mehta Jati's ensemble paid tribute to the craftsmanship of Bengal 'shola' artisans

craftsmanship of Bengal artisans. In a gold and silver Kanjivaram silk outfit, designer Mayyur Girotra incorporated intricate shola work. 'Shola' has long been an integral part of Bengali rituals, used in the making of crowns, floral motifs and ornaments. This soon-to-be-forgotten craft found its place in high fashion at the Met Gala, paying tribute to Bengal's rich artistic heritage.



MET GALA 2026



INTERPRETING THE IDEA OF BODY AS A CANVAS THROUGH COUTURE

The event once again brought together leading names from entertainment, music and fashion

The Met Gala 2026, held at the Metropolitan Museum of Art, unfolded around the theme 'Costume Art', with a dress code centred on 'Fashion Is Art' on May 5 (IST). As one of the most celebrated nights in global fashion, the event once again brought together leading names from entertainment, music and fashion, with each celebrity interpreting the idea of the body as a canvas through couture.

Beyonce: Also serving as a co-chair this year, she made a dramatic entrance in a crystal-covered gown crafted to mimic the structure of a human skeleton, paired with a coordinating headpiece that amplified the theme. Elevating the ensemble further, she added a statement faux fur coat, while a diamond necklace and matching earrings brought an added layer of glamour to the overall look.

Rihanna: The singer brought high-impact glamour to the gala in a shimmering silver Maison Margiela look by Glenn Martens. The outfit featured a crystal-encrusted bodice paired with a sculptural, cocoon-like structure and a sleek, fitted skirt. She kept accessories minimal, letting the metallic textures and bejewelled finish

take centre stage.

Anne Hathaway: The actress, who has been busy promoting 'The Devil Wears Prada 2', brought a regal touch to the red carpet. She wore a strapless Michael Kors ball gown featuring a deep neckline, with hand-painted detailing by artist Peter McGough to align with the 'Costume Art' theme. She completed the look with a Bvlgari choker and stud earrings, styling her hair in a neat bun.

Emily Blunt: 'The Devil Wears Prada 2' star made a striking appearance, pairing a structured black corset top and tailored slacks by Ashi Studio with an extraordinary jewellery piece. She wore a rare Mikimoto body necklace valued at around 500,000 dollars, crafted with thousands of 'Akoya' pearls. The design featured a statement collar set with a 21.85-carat pear-shaped morganite, surrounded by nearly 46 carats of diamonds, making it the standout element of her look.

Katy Perry: The singer brought a futuristic, concept-driven look to the gala in a white strapless gown by Stella McCartney, crafted from repurposed Italian duchess satin. The outfit featured a flowing cape and matching gloves. She completed the look with a striking white-and-silver headpiece by

Miodrag Guberinic, designed to explore themes of identity, perception and the blurred line between reality and illusion.

Madonna: She delivered one of the most theatrical moments at the event in a custom Saint Laurent look inspired by surrealist artist Leonora Carrington. She arrived with multiple attendants carrying her sheer violet cape, adding to the dramatic entrance. The outfit featured a black satin and lace slip dress layered with a translucent organza cape. Completing the look was an elaborate headpiece shaped like a ship.

Nicole Kidman: The 'Scarpetta' star attended the event alongside her daughter, Sunday Rose Kidman Urban. Serving as a co-chair for the evening, she wore a custom Chanel ensemble designed by Matthieu Blazy. The look featured a shimmering finish with fur detailing, drawing inspiration from the glamour of 'Moulin Rouge'. Her daughter accompanied her as her plus-one, wearing a voluminous Dior gown.

Blake Lively: She wore a custom 'Versace' ensemble featuring a fitted bodice and a flowing train in soft pastel shades. The look, based on a vintage 'Versace' design, was updated with an extended train for the event. She also carried a custom Judith Leiber piece featuring

artwork by her children.

Heidi Klum: Embracing the 'Costume Art' theme, she appeared in a custom creation by Mike Marino that transformed her into a statue-like figure. The outfit featured a sculpted, stone-textured finish that mimicked carved marble, extending across both her gown and face, creating the illusion of a living artwork brought to life.

Kim Kardashian: The 'Met Gala' regular wore a bronze-toned breastplate teamed with an open skirt, created alongside artist Allen Jones and Whitaker Malem Creative and inspired by a 1960s body cast. Staying true to her experimental red carpet style, she switched to blonde hair styled by Chris Appleton and arrived solo, letting the outfit take centre stage.

Hailey Bieber: She embraced the sculptural trend at the gala with a striking Saint Laurent look. She wore a 24-carat gold-moulded bodice paired with a flowing silk chiffon skirt and an extended lavallière detail. The ensemble was completed with metallic leather 'Babylone' sandals, adding a polished finish to the look.

Cara Delevingne: She made an early appearance on the gala's red carpet in a striking black gown. From the front, the sleeveless, high-neck design with vel-

vet detailing gave a more covered, structured look. However, the back revealed a dramatic sheer panel adorned with intricate black beadwork arranged in a feather-like pattern that extended down the spine and into a flowing train. She styled her hair in a sleek updo and paired the look with deep-toned nails, adding to the overall dark, gothic-inspired aesthetic.

Gigi Hadid: The model brought a soft, romantic touch to the event in a custom sheer Miu Miu gown. The outfit featured delicate floral embroidery, crystal detailing and patchwork elements that aligned with the body-focused theme of the evening. She completed the look with loose, flowing waves styled by Dimitris Giannetos - dubbed 'Miu Miu waves' - created using layered hair extensions to add natural volume and dimension.

Sabrina Carpenter: She wore a custom 'Dior' creation by Jonathan Anderson. Her look paid tribute to the 1954 film 'Sabrina', featuring a sheer tulle dress wrapped in rhinestone-studded filmstrip motifs showcasing scenes from the movie. She paired the outfit with a statement headpiece that also incorporated imagery from the film, while her soft, old Hollywood-inspired curls completed the vintage-inspired aesthetic.

